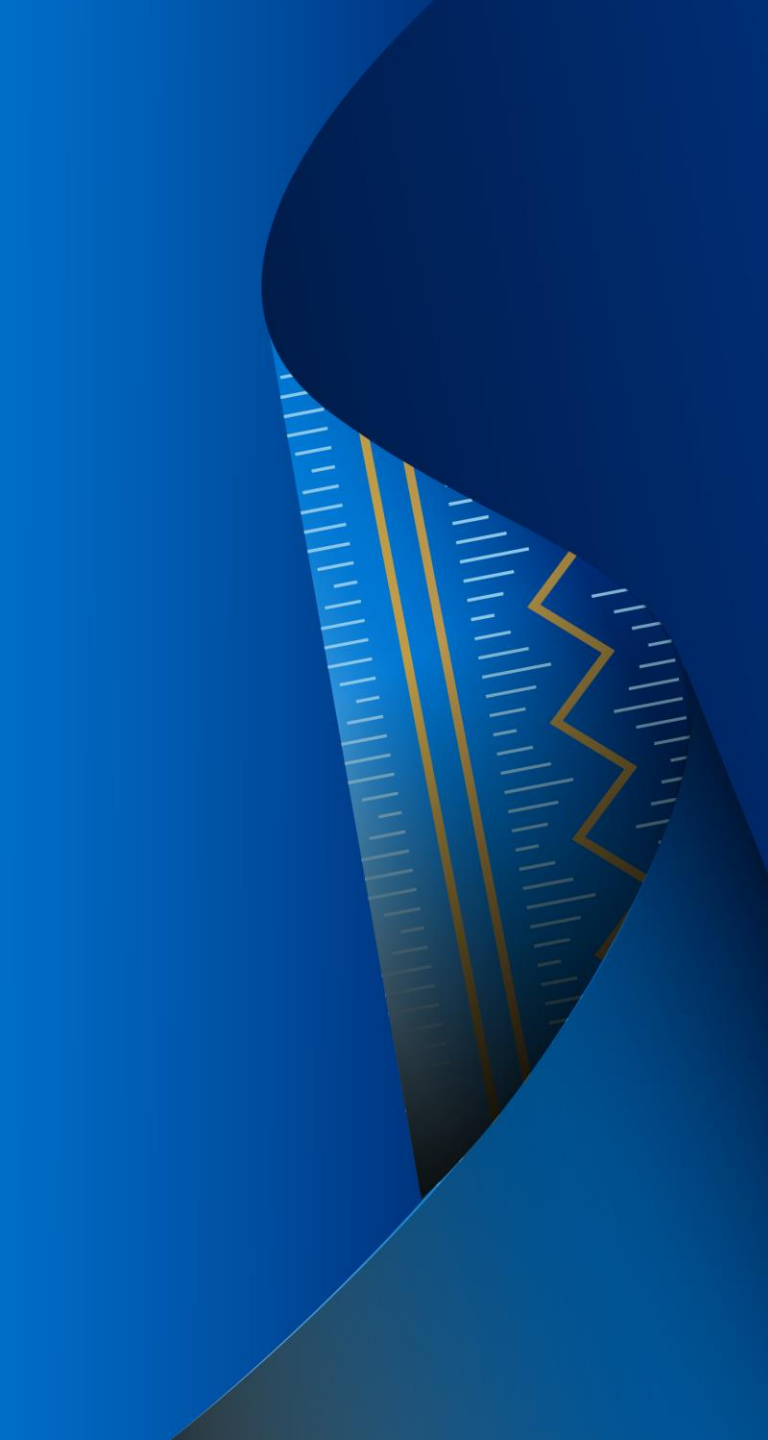




Winning holiday moments: Practical strategies for seasonal success

Best practices this holiday - Agenda

1

Phase 1 – Wrap the Basics - July & August

Generative Engine Optimization (GEO), Product Feeds, Measurement, and Bidding Foundations

2

Phase 2 – Gift them a Reason - September & October

Create Consideration Early

3

Phase 3- Ring in the Sales - November & December

Capture the Holiday Moment

4

Phase 4- Unbox What's Next – December & January

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot messaging, capture post-holiday demand and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

What you'll be able to do this holiday season

1

Phase 1 · Prepare for success — audit product feeds, confirm conversion tracking, and structure your full-funnel campaign mix across Search, Shopping, PMax, and AI Max before demand builds.

2

Phase 2 · Engage shoppers early with seasonal in-market audiences, remarketing, and fresh creative to build demand before peak.

3

Phase 3 · Capture peak demand using automated bidding, seasonality adjustments, and conversion value rules during Cyber Week.

4

Phase 4 · Measure and learn by evaluating results, accounting for conversion delays, and applying learnings to next season.

Today's speakers



Monica Orsino *(pronouns)*
Senior Learning Consultant

What's changing this Holiday season



For years, shoppers searched for products. Now they're asking AI what to buy.



Holiday shoppers aren't just searching — they're asking, comparing, validating, and deciding within AI-powered experiences.



Brands that are easy to find are no longer enough. Brands must be easy for AI to understand, recommend, and trust.

The Three Eras of Holiday Shopping

Shopping now spans three connected webs. AI readiness is the through-line that carries brands across all of them.

Human web

Shoppers search, browse, and click — the classic query-and-results journey. Visibility is won through search and strong product listings.

LLM web

Shoppers ask AI what to buy. Discovery happens inside conversational answers, so brands must be easy for AI to find, understand, and recommend.

Agentic web

AI agents act on the shopper's behalf — comparing, validating, and completing purchases. Feed quality and product discoverability become decisive.

The four phases of Holiday

Phase 01 - Wrap the Basics - July & August

Product Feeds, Measurement, and Bidding Foundations

Phase 03 - Ring in the Sales - November & December

Capture the Holiday Moment

Phase 02 - Gift them a Reason - September & October

Create Consideration Early

Phase 04 - Unbox What's Next - December & January

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot messaging, capture post-holiday demand and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

Phase 1: Wrap the Basics

Phase 01

Wrap the basics & get setup for success – **July / August**

A strong holiday strategy starts with the right foundation

The fundamentals still win with:

- **well-structured media mix** with the optimal campaign portfolio;
- **reviewed and accurate product feed**,
- **Universal Event Tracking (UET) and Merchant Center** correctly set up
- **measurement** must be in place with clear **conversion tracking, automated bidding, and meaningful conversion values**,
- **first-party data** and relevant **seasonal audiences** reach the right customers at the right time.

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 1:

Prep & planning

Before demand peaks



"We've already learned everything from last year."

"Black Friday is when holiday starts."

"Remarketing audiences will build themselves."

- Consumer behavior, competition, and shopping trends evolve every season.
- Winning advertisers start building demand, audiences, and momentum weeks before peak shopping events.
- Success is built before Cyber Week through audience growth, testing, and campaign learning.
- Strong audience pools require early planning and accumulation.



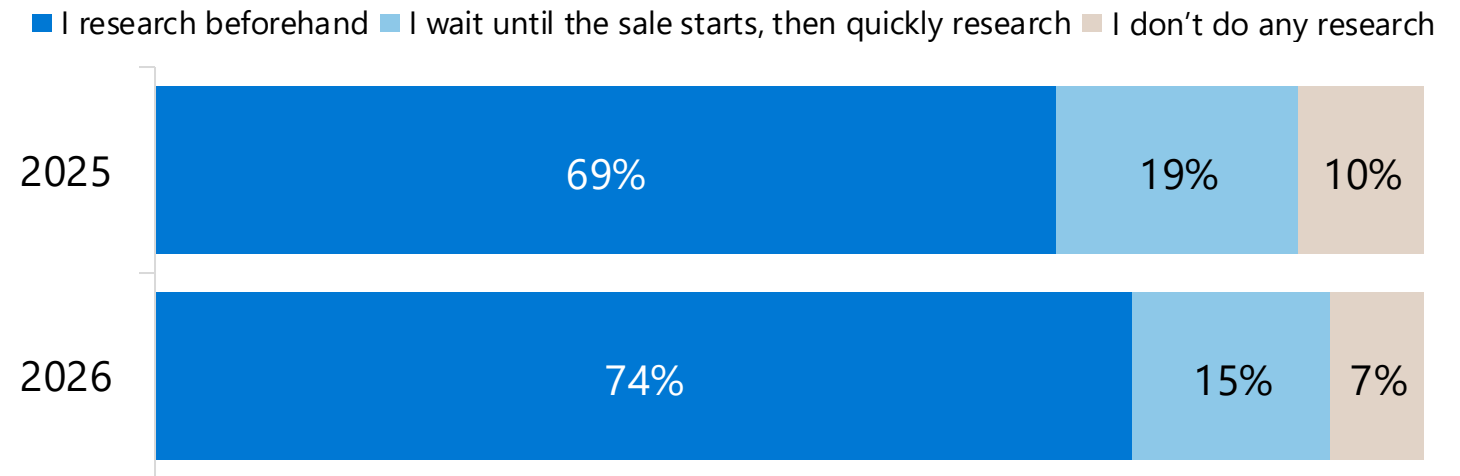
Shoppers are planning earlier for major sales events

Nearly **3 in 4 shoppers** now research products before Black Friday and/or Cyber Monday.

Build visibility before promotions go live with Search, Shopping Campaigns, PMax, and Audience Ads to reach shoppers while they are still researching, comparing, and building shortlists.

Approach to product research for key shopping events

Share of Respondents



Note: responses may not sum to 100% as the response "unsure" was removed.

Survey QQ: Which of the following statements best describes how you approach researching products for a shopping event, such as Black Friday or Cyber Monday?

Why AI readiness matters

The internet is the world's largest holiday shopping mall. AI is the personal shopper.

Winning this season depends on making it easy for AI to find, understand, trust, and recommend your products.



The fundamentals still win:

- strong measurement
- high-quality product data
- relevant creative
- effective campaigns

Now optimized for an AI-driven world.

Microsoft Retail & CPG audiences are meaningfully more affluent

Microsoft vs. Google Income

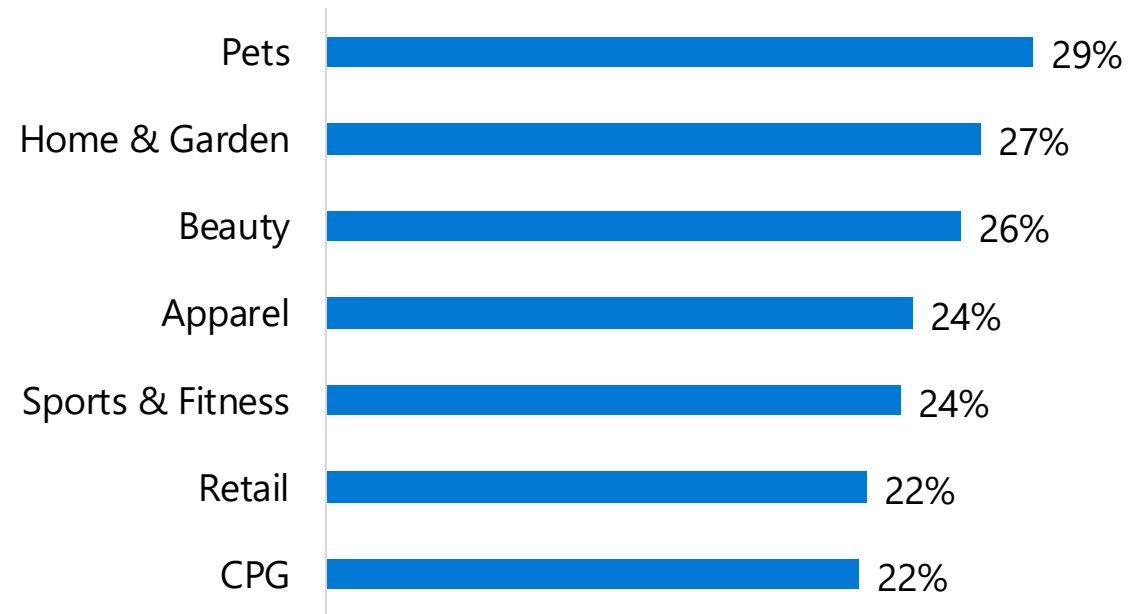
+12%

Higher household income
vs. Google Advertising shoppers

- ✓ Shift budgets into Microsoft Advertising to better support your premium and/or higher consideration products.
- ✓ Ensure Merchant Center is up-to-date to capture full product catalog.

Microsoft shoppers over-index on premium products

Microsoft vs. Google Premium Product Shoppers
(% higher index over Google)

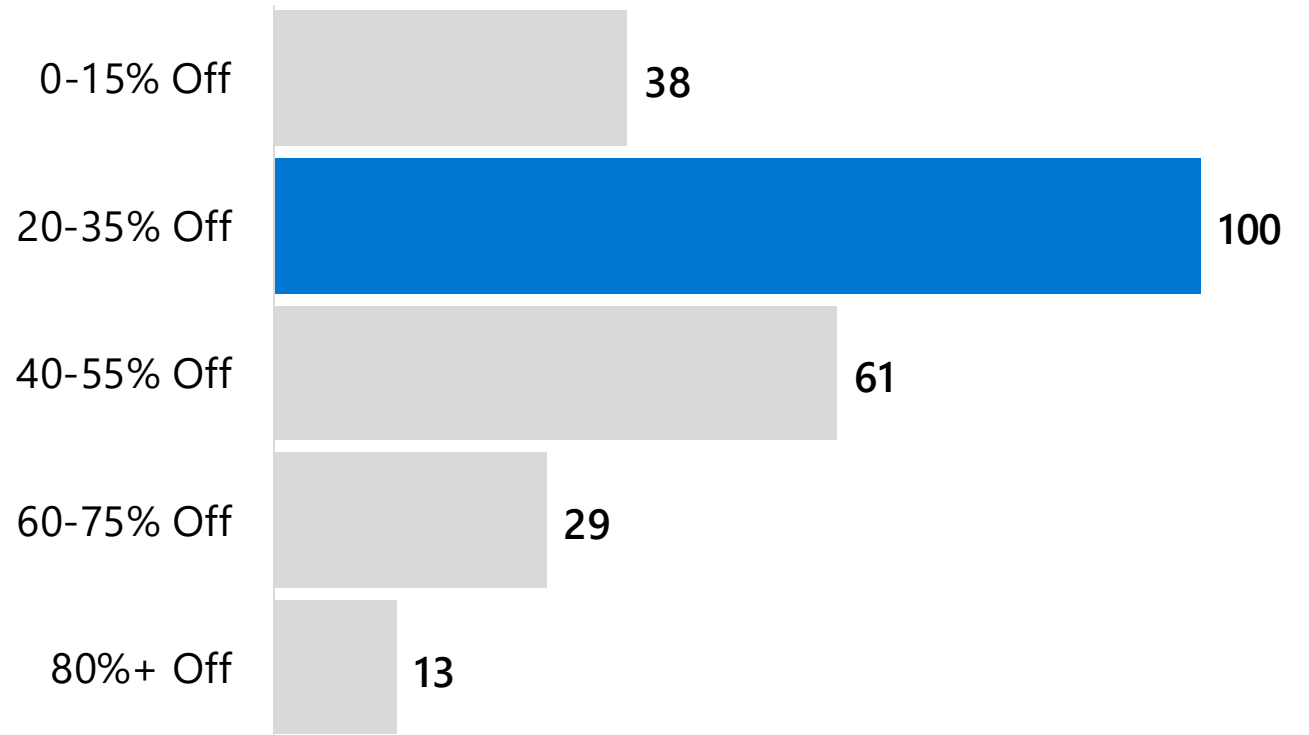


Holiday shoppers are mostly searching for 20-35% offers

Shoppers seek meaningful savings without waiting for extreme markdowns.

- ✓ Tease offers early with Audience Ads to build awareness.
- ✓ Use Merchant Promotions to highlight available deals.

Q4 indexed search volume by offer



Search and AI are converging



Search and AI are converging into more conversational, intent-rich customer journeys.



The average length of queries on Bing is up 11%.

As customers add context, AI understands intent better — creating opportunities for advertisers ready to be discovered, understood, and recommended across search and AI experiences.

Build structures that support learning



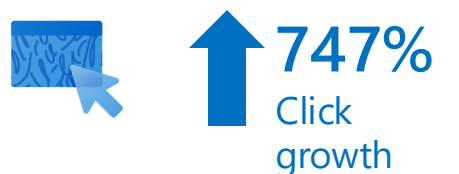
- **Consolidate fragmented campaigns** when volume is limited — a campaign with fewer than 30 conversions in 30 days is a candidate for consolidation.
- Reserve **Exact Match** for critical coverage of **must-have search terms**.
- Use **Broad Match, AI Max, and Performance Max** as the exploration layer to **capture incremental demand** across Search, Copilot, and other surfaces.
- Consider **portfolio bid strategies** for groups of campaigns with similar intent and margins.

JD Sports

Enters its next growth phase with an AI-ready strategy after **clicks jump 747%**



The results



Summary

- **The goal:** Prepare for AI-driven discovery during peak season
- **The solution:** Align campaigns with key business priorities
- **The strategy:** PMAX to capture cross-channel demand, Broad Match to expand relevant queries, and Auto-Bidding to react in real-time
- **The results:** Record revenue when demand was highest

“We know that our customers are increasingly using AI-enabled experiences for inspiration. We want to show up for our customers where they are, so we launched a new AI-led structure ahead of peak. This gave the platform a fuller view of intent, turning inspiration moments into buying decisions.”

Liza Nolan

Associate Director of Digital Media
JD Sports

Maximize coverage across Microsoft Advertising

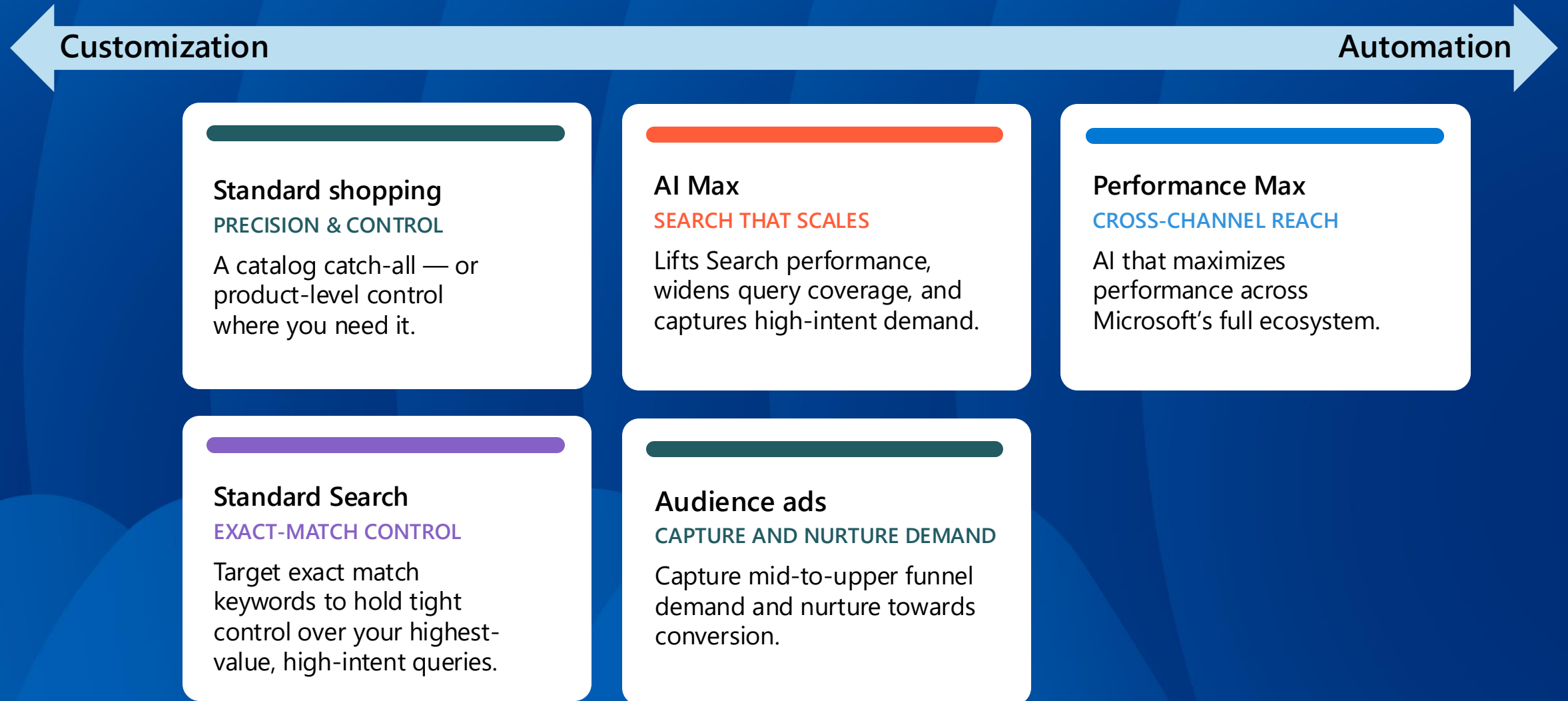
Different campaign types serve different objectives.



Most advertisers benefit from multiple solutions working together.

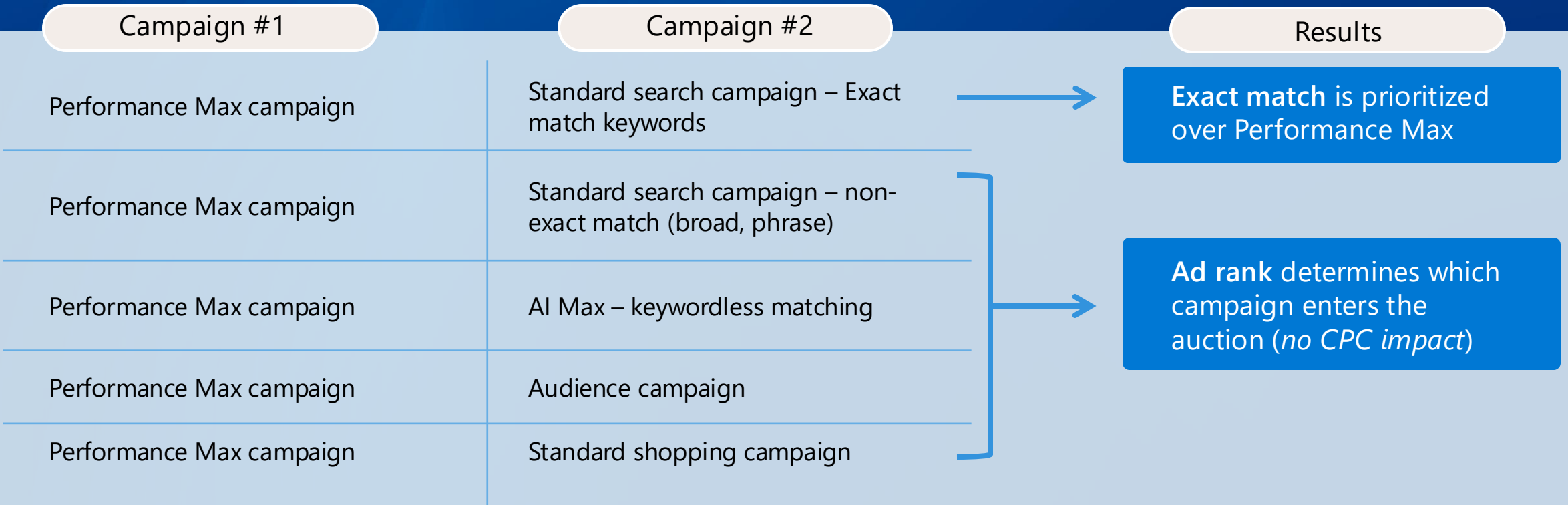


Selecting the right campaign mix



How different campaigns interact with each other

Ad delivery for Search campaigns using exact match keywords is prioritized over Performance Max campaigns. For all other campaign types, the campaign with the highest ad rank will serve.

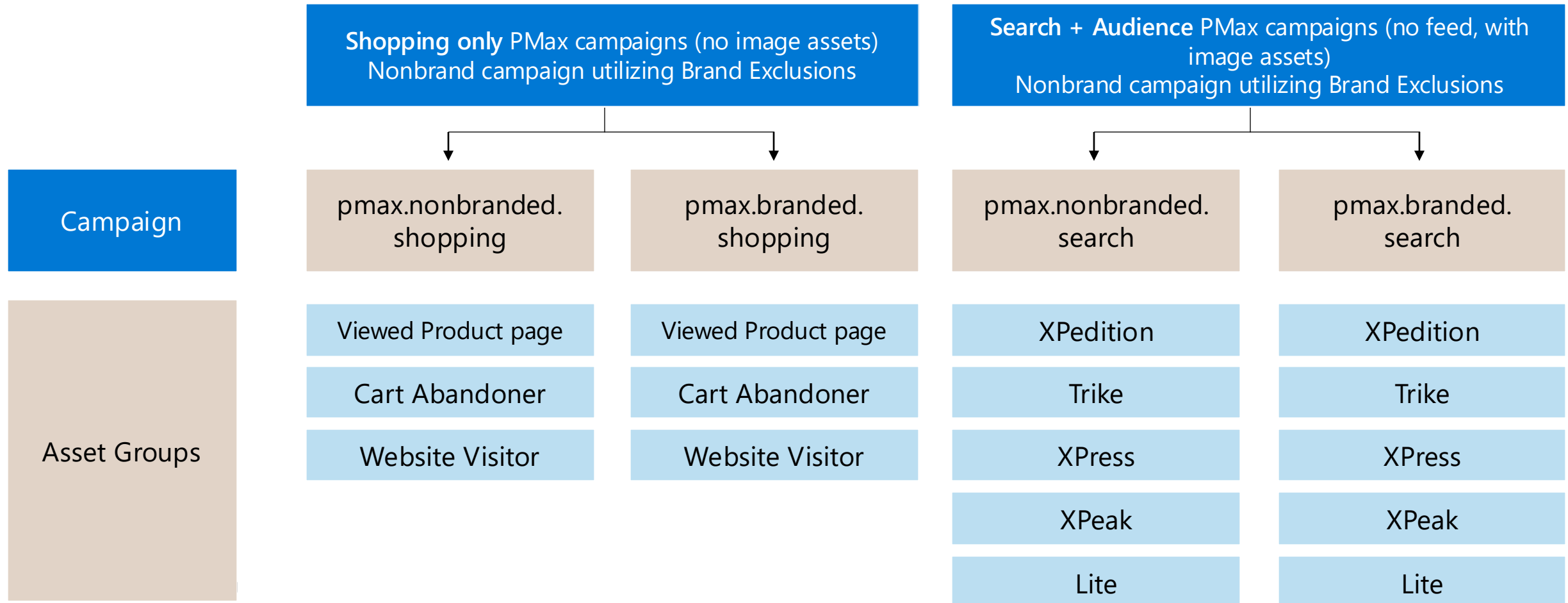


Retail Client Campaign Structure example

Example: Large advertiser breaks out by shopping network vs Search + audience and then by brand and non-brand.

Shopping campaigns further broken by audiences and Search + audience are broken by product type at asset group level

Remember: Ensure that your campaigns can hit the baseline number of conversions (At least 30 conversions in 30 days).

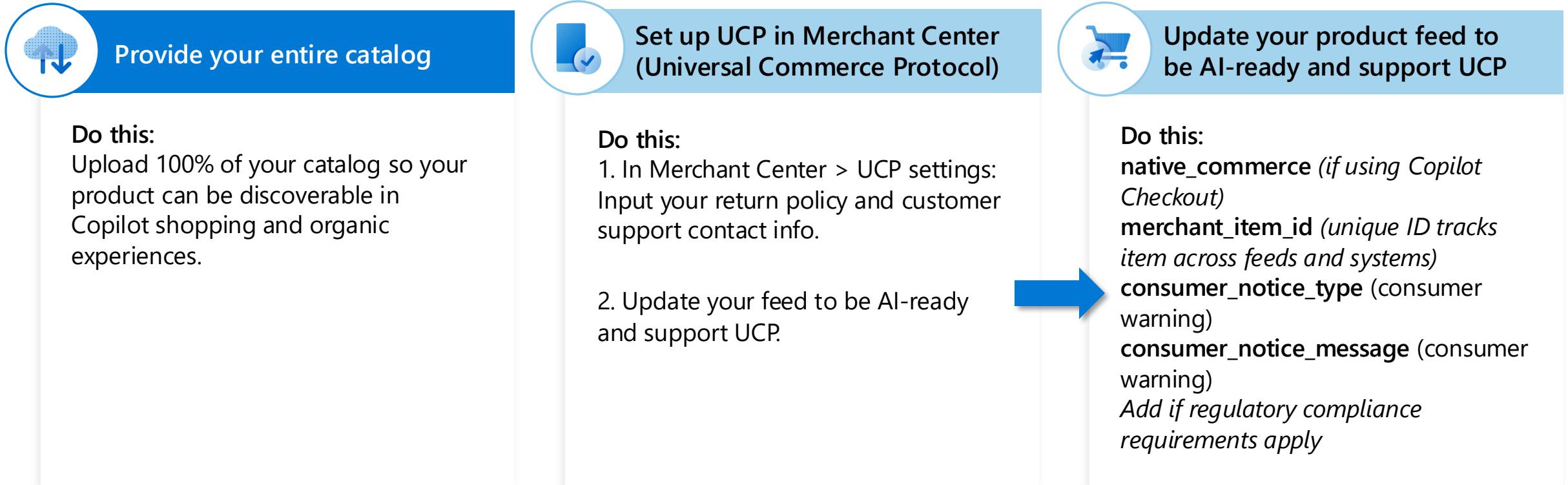


AI readiness in Merchant Center

Enabling agentic shopping experiences in Copilot starts with product discoverability.

Make your products discoverable.

Show up in Copilot conversations with the product information shoppers need to make purchase decisions. Richer product details help improve Copilot answers and drive greater engagement



Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist



THE BASICS

Double check the foundation is in place.

- ☐ **Upload your entire product catalog for AI readiness** so products are discoverable in Copilot shopping.
- ☐ **Required fields** are complete
- ☐ **No duplicate titles**
Differentiate titles for variant offerings with the color, size, materials, etc.
- ☐ **GTIN/MPN** is valid
- ☐ **Pricing** is correct and up to date
- ☐ **Product page URLs** correct and work
- ☐ **All products** are included in feed
- ☐ **Image URL** should be accessible and have a good image of your product
- ☐ Use **custom labels** to tag holiday hero products, best sellers, and strategic inventory



THE OPPORTUNITIES

More details in feeds is better.

- ☐ **Strong product titles**
Create robust titles with product details.
- ☐ **Long product descriptions**
Confirm accuracy and that they match landing page descriptions.
- ☐ **Recommended fields**
Provide more metadata to help ads match to more relevant searches.
- ☐ **Product categorization**
Clarify what your product is.
- ☐ **Routine updates to feed**
Automate price and status updates.
- ☐ **Confirm feed parity with Google.**
Get the same products. Import can help.
- ☐ **UCP attributes.**
Add return policy, customer support

Top driver: Optimize product title

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Travel sized lavender hand cream

Product title:

Make your Product Titles as robust as possible.

Include brand details, key search terms, and product attributes:

Brand + Product Name + Product Type + Gender + Size + Color (if applicable)

Test the order of product attributes in your title to understand which will drive most relevant traffic.



Run Search Term Reports to see which queries are triggering Product ads

Don't:



Put seasonal marketing messages in the product title.*

*unless the product itself is specifically a gift item. I.e. Thanksgiving *gift basket*, Christmas *ornament*, etc.

Top driver: Optimize product description

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"  Travel sized lavender hand cream

Product description:

- Ensure descriptions are relevant, descriptive, and include special callouts around holidays.
- Include Microsoft Advertising key terms for both title and description to help with product understanding and matching.
- Add Holiday context by highlighting seasonal uses cases:
 - Holiday entertaining, gifts for ___, or occasions (family gatherings).

Don't:



Insert keywords into every product description:

- "Great Christmas Gift" or "Best Black Friday Sale"



Forget to adjust product descriptions post-holiday season.

Product description should match with landing page product details and features.



Top driver: Optimize product titles & descriptions for holiday

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Good:

Travel sized lavender **hand cream**

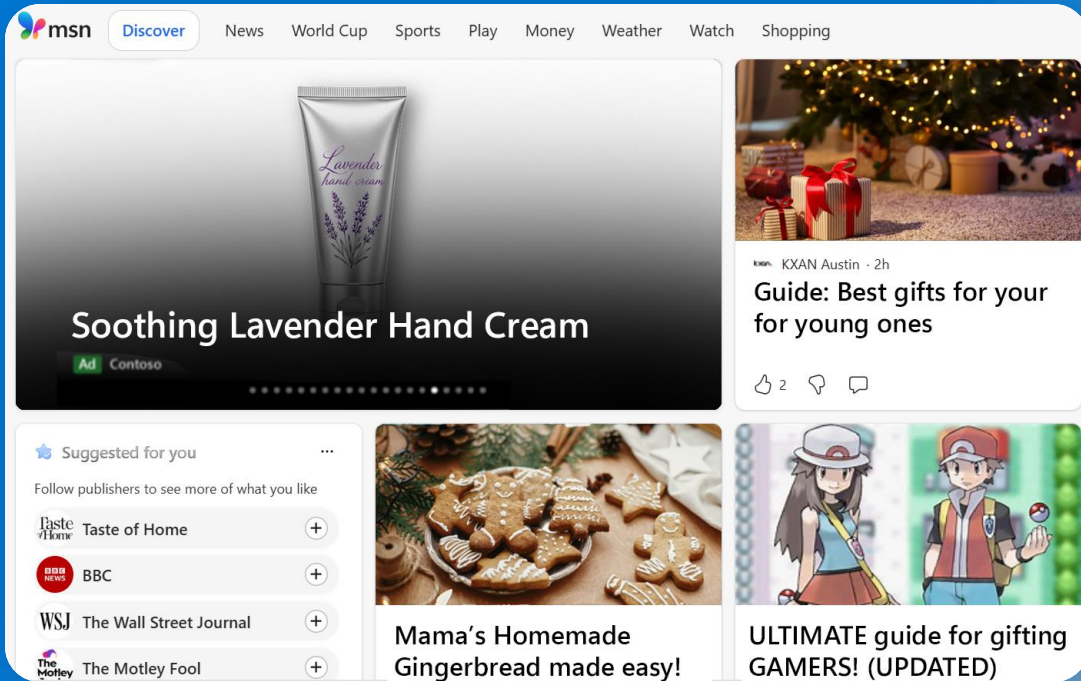
Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this smooth, **light-textured cream** gently helps to nourish the hands leaving them softly perfumed.

Better for holidays:

2.6 oz lavender shea butter **hand cream**

Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this **lightweight hand cream** helps nourish hands and leave them softly perfumed. At **2.6 oz**, it's ideal as a **small gift for a coworker**, and it provides the nourishment needed during the **wintertime**.

Expand your feed to display and native placements



Use your existing feed from search and expand into display and native.

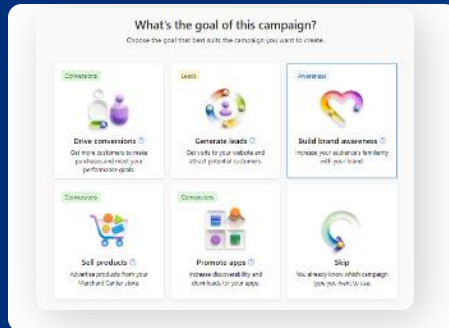


When combined with Microsoft AI intent signals, we'll match users with the items in your feed that they've shown interest in.

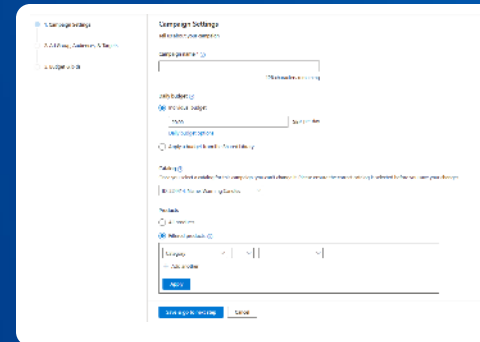
Set up your feed-based campaign

Four easy steps to set up, campaign creation in two minutes or less!

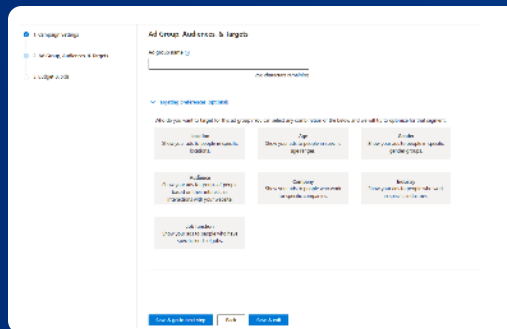
1. Create New Campaign and select 'Sell Products' as your campaign goal and 'Audience' as your campaign type



2. Set Campaign Name, choose store and select 'All Products' filter. We recommend no product filters to maximize volume.

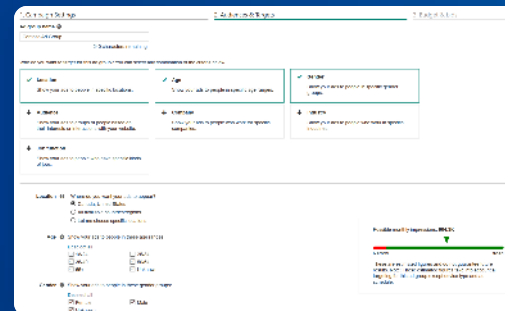


3. Choose your audience and targeting.



4. Set Daily Budget and Default Bid.

We recommend ~10% of Search shopping spend as a starting point and a minimum of \$2.00 bid to start.



IMPORTANT TIPS TO REMEMBER

- Must have an active shopping feed to launch.
- UET is highly recommended, but not required.
- Allow 24-48 hours for delivery to begin ramping.

Shopping powered by Microsoft Audience Signals

How it works

- Users who engage with an advertiser's products on their site, a reseller's website, or who have searched relevant keywords are identified and targeted via Microsoft first-party data signal.
- Ads are created utilizing existing Shopping feed components, just like Dynamic Remarketing.

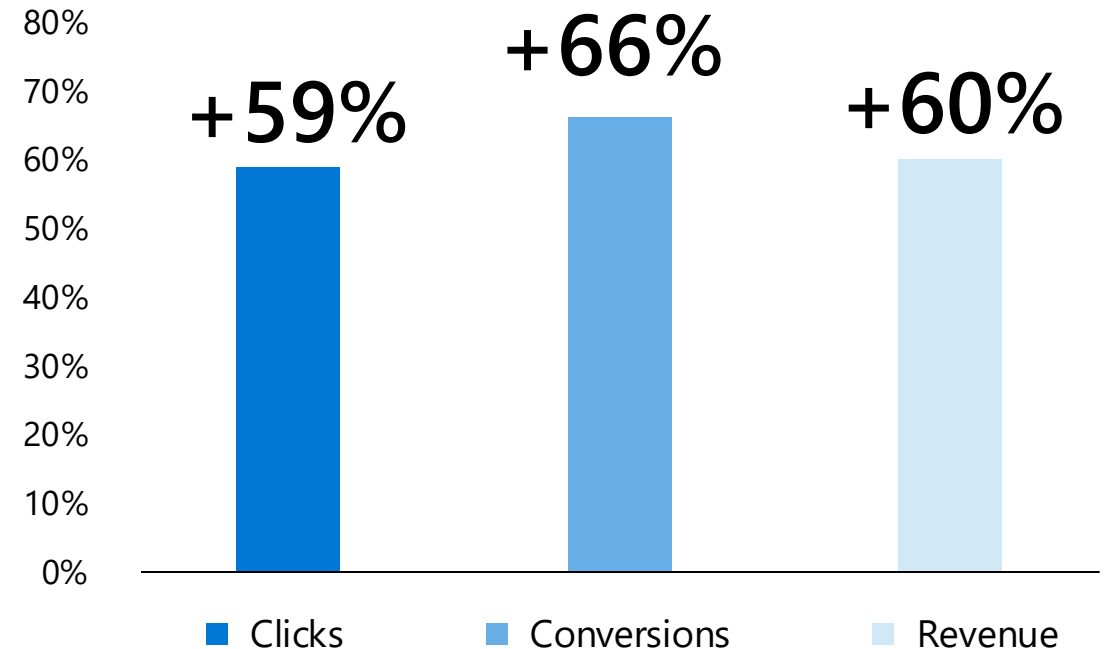
Benefits

- Minimal effort required—no need for extra ads, tag modifications or extra feeds.
- Allows you to recognise and target consumers who have expressed interest in your products not just on your own site, but also on reseller or competitor sites, even if they haven't visited your website directly.

1. Microsoft Internal Case Study Data—Apparel client—May–September 2023. Microsoft Audience Network Shopping ad performance compared to Search Shopping ad performance over the same period

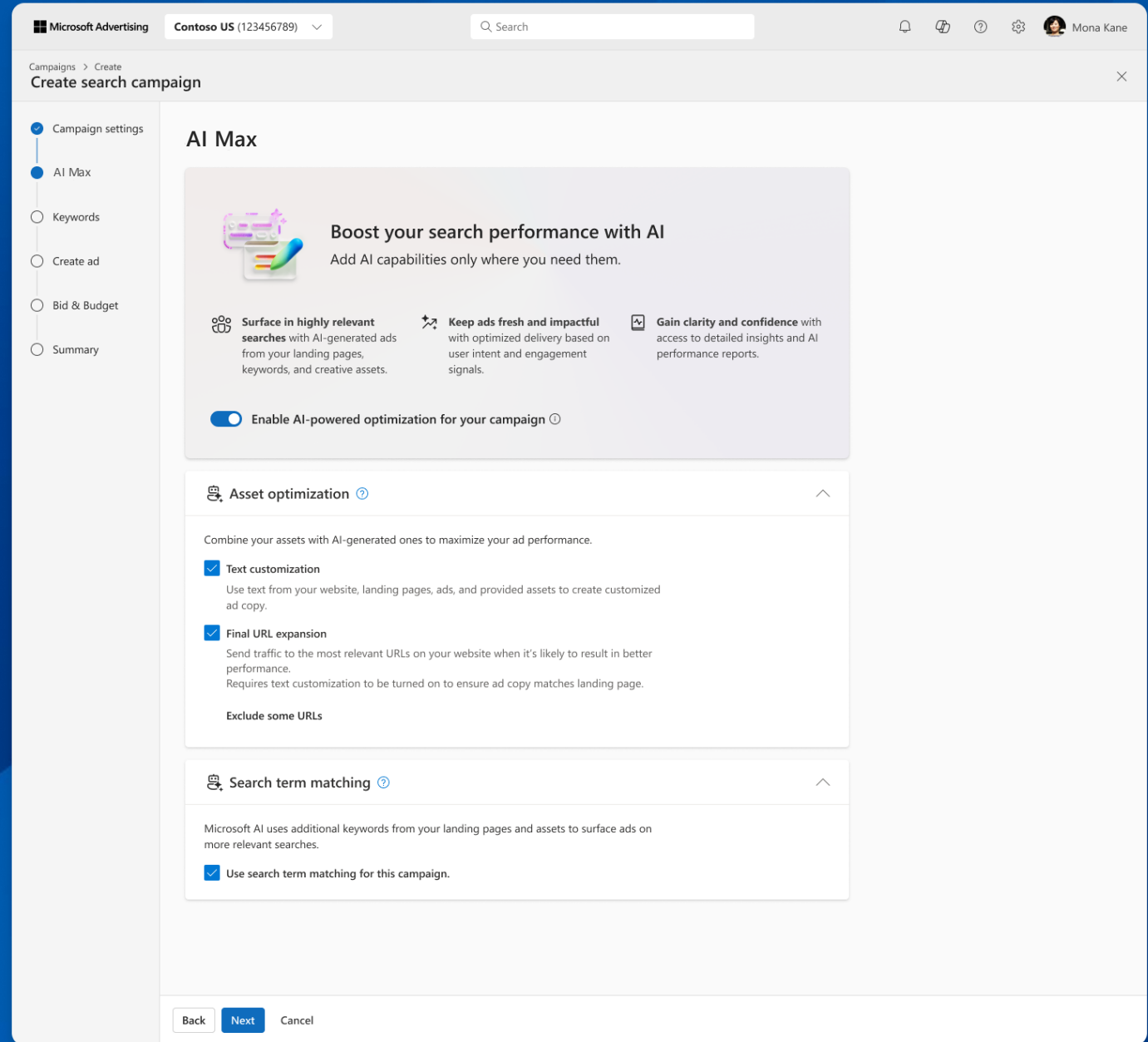
For one Apparel advertiser without UET++, Shopping ads powered by Microsoft Audience Signals drove **\$1.2M in incremental revenue**, at a ROAS **56% more efficient** than Search Shopping ads over the same period.

Results vs Search Shopping ads



AI Max overview

AI Max is an **optional** Search campaign feature that uses the best of Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches by using advertiser-provided content and real-time signals.



The screenshot shows the 'Create search campaign' interface in the Microsoft Advertising console. The left sidebar contains a navigation menu with the following items: Campaign settings (selected), AI Max, Keywords, Create ad, Bid & Budget, and Summary. The main content area is titled 'AI Max' and features a section titled 'Boost your search performance with AI' with the subtitle 'Add AI capabilities only where you need them.' Below this, there are three benefit cards: 'Surface in highly relevant searches' (AI-generated ads from landing pages, keywords, and creative assets), 'Keep ads fresh and impactful' (optimized delivery based on user intent and engagement signals), and 'Gain clarity and confidence' (access to detailed insights and AI performance reports). A toggle switch labeled 'Enable AI-powered optimization for your campaign' is currently turned on. Below the AI Max section, there are two expandable sections: 'Asset optimization' and 'Search term matching'. The 'Asset optimization' section includes 'Text customization' (checked) and 'Final URL expansion' (checked), with an option to 'Exclude some URLs'. The 'Search term matching' section includes 'Use search term matching for this campaign' (checked). At the bottom of the interface, there are 'Back', 'Next', and 'Cancel' buttons.

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789) Search

Campaigns > Create
Create search campaign

Campaign settings
AI Max
Keywords
Create ad
Bid & Budget
Summary

AI Max

 **Boost your search performance with AI**
Add AI capabilities only where you need them.

-  **Surface in highly relevant searches** with AI-generated ads from your landing pages, keywords, and creative assets.
-  **Keep ads fresh and impactful** with optimized delivery based on user intent and engagement signals.
-  **Gain clarity and confidence** with access to detailed insights and AI performance reports.

☒ Enable AI-powered optimization for your campaign ⓘ

Asset optimization ⓘ

Combine your assets with AI-generated ones to maximize your ad performance.

- ☒ **Text customization**
Use text from your website, landing pages, ads, and provided assets to create customized ad copy.
- ☒ **Final URL expansion**
Send traffic to the most relevant URLs on your website when it's likely to result in better performance.
Requires text customization to be turned on to ensure ad copy matches landing page.

Exclude some URLs

Search term matching ⓘ

Microsoft AI uses additional keywords from your landing pages and assets to surface ads on more relevant searches.

- ☒ Use search term matching for this campaign.

Back Next Cancel

AI Max: Why now & what you gain

Helping you **stay ahead of the curve** — why AI Max matters now and the gains it delivers.

REACH

Search is evolving, with new intent-driven queries every day that keyword lists can't anticipate.

AI Max: expands reach with AI-powered term matching that surfaces incremental queries and conversions.

RELEVANCE

Keywords and ads struggle to stay relevant to long-tail and emerging Search queries.

AI Max: personalizes creative at scale through dynamic text customization.

RESULTS

You need to connect with customers and drive stronger results—without adding manual work.

AI Max: optimizes destinations, expanding final URLs and routing traffic to the best landing page.

How does AI Max differ from Performance Max?

AI Max — an optional layer that **adds automation to standard Search**: it expands matching, personalizes creative, and routes users to the most relevant landing page, while keeping the control and transparency of Search. It **augments Search campaigns** rather than replacing them.

Performance Max — a separate **cross-channel campaign type** built to maximize reach and automation **across all of Microsoft's channels**, trading some control for full automation.

Which to choose — use AI Max to enhance Search with a balance of control and automation; use Performance Max for maximum reach and automation across every channel.

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together

How should I think about using PMax and Audience ads together?

Audience ads are better suited to advertisers who want a more targeted campaign and have goals at **upper points of the funnel**, not just conversion focused.

PMax campaigns provide broader, more automated reach and focus more on **bottom-funnel users** who are ready to convert.

Ad group targeting

Select the audience categories that you want to target for the ad groups, and then select the targeting settings. [Learn more](#)

In-market audiences ▾

Audience name	List size	Select all
In-market audiences: 17		
Online Black Friday Shopping	217K	+
Christmas Shopping	138M	+
After-Christmas Sale Shopping	36.3K	+
In-Store Christmas Shopping	15.9K	+
Online Christmas Shopping	6.58M	+
India Independence Day	20.9K	+

Selected : 1

Audience name	List size
Seasonal Shopping/Christmas Shopping/Online Christmas Shopping	6.58M

Remove all

Signals (Optional)

Signals give us valuable information about who you want to reach. We'll use them as a starting point to find customers and determine who sees your ads.

Audience

Create or add an audience signal to guide automation.

dog lovers

All ages; All genders

Home & Garden/Pet Supplies

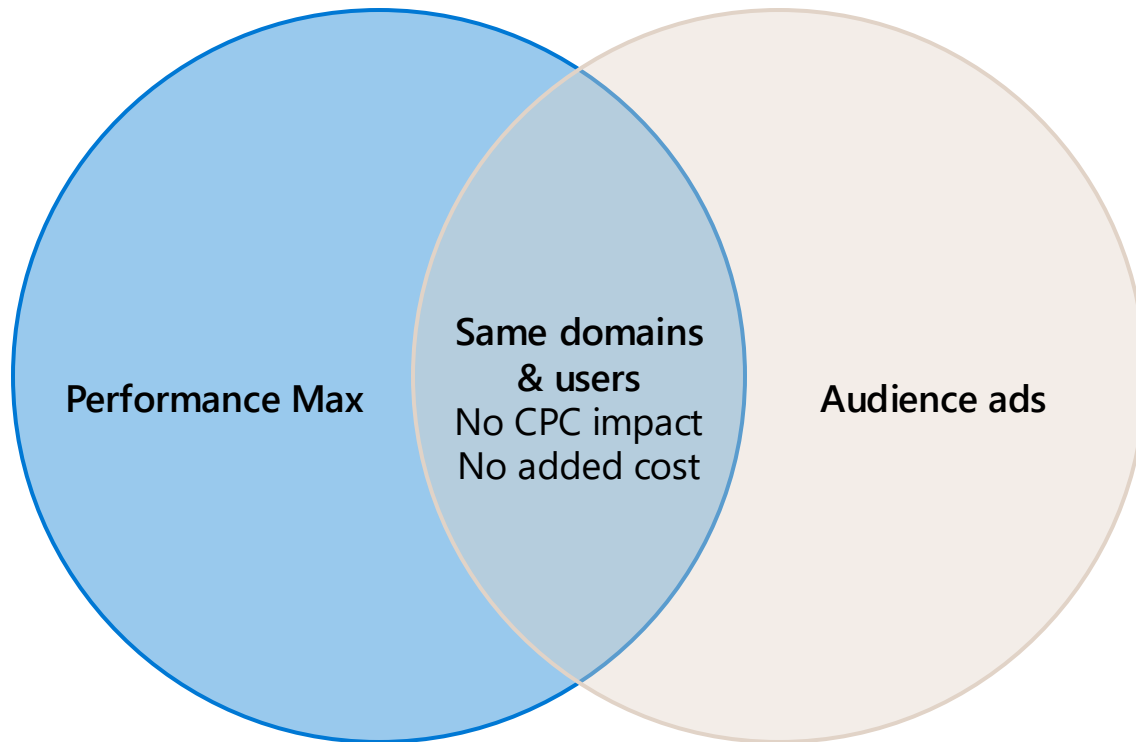
Home & Garden/Pet Supplies/Dog Food & Supplies

Seasonal Shopping/Black Friday Shopping/In-Store Black Friday Shopping

Marketing Arts and Design Finance Information Technology

Ready (Limited)

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together



Is there a risk of cannibalization between PMax and Audience ads?

- **No CPC impact:** Even if both campaigns target the same domain, they don't compete or drive up costs. This holds true across accounts.
- **Audience overlap:** If campaigns share identical goals, they may pursue the same users. However, this does not affect CPCs or overall cost.

Shared targeting overlaps the same users and domains, but the two campaign types never compete or raise CPCs.

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together

Better together

When using both campaigns together you should:

- ✓ Tailor messaging
- ✓ Keep PMax always-on
- ✓ Leverage creative insights
- ✓ Set appropriate CPA/ROAS goals



Top tip!

Set up an 'always on' Audience ads campaign that fuels your impression-based remarketing list.



Use this impression-based remarketing list as an audience signal on your PMax campaign.

Considerations for PMax

Even with Performance Max included as part of your strategy, **you can have a more advanced setup with controls.**



SHOPPING:

- PMax can be used for all shopping needs, unless a separate campaign is desired for more control (e.g. brand vs. non-brand)
- In case your PMax campaign becomes budget-capped, shopping campaigns can also be used as a “catch-all” under PMax

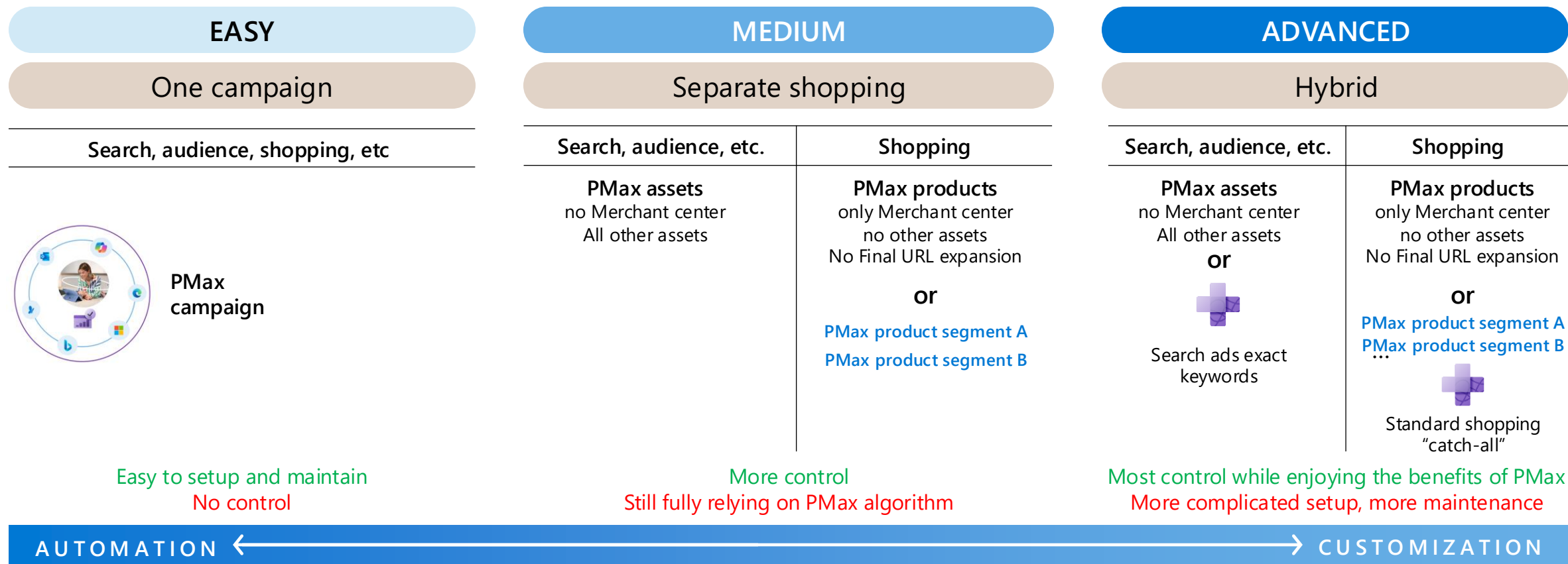


PMax vs. NON-EXACT MATCH PRODUCTS:

- If client wants to continue using other campaigns for more control, focus non-exact match products
- (e.g., DSA or shopping) on specific **targets** or **objectives** that are **different from the PMax campaign**

If separating out other campaigns to control for different targets or objectives, the more your client can categorize their different products, URLs, and goals, the more helpful for overall performance.

Easy to advanced campaign approaches – PMax for Retail example



Search themes keys to success

Seasonal

Travel Tuesday ✕ Black Friday Car Rental Discounts ✕
Travel Deals ✕ (Brand Promotion Name) ✕

Pro tip: Set up tightly defined, but diverse, Search Themes to provide a specific signal to more effectively guide the algorithm.

Search Themes ?

Words or phrases that people search for on Bing (up to 50)

black friday sports apparel deals ✕
cyber monday athletic wear sale ✕

black friday gym clothes discounts ✕
cyber monday workout gear deals ✕

(brand promotion name) ✕
athletic wear clearance sale ✕

limited time fitness apparel sale ✕
best black friday running gear deals ✕

gifts for runners ✕
fitness gifts for men ✕
workout gifts for women ✕

christmas gifts for athletes ✕
activewear gift ideas ✕

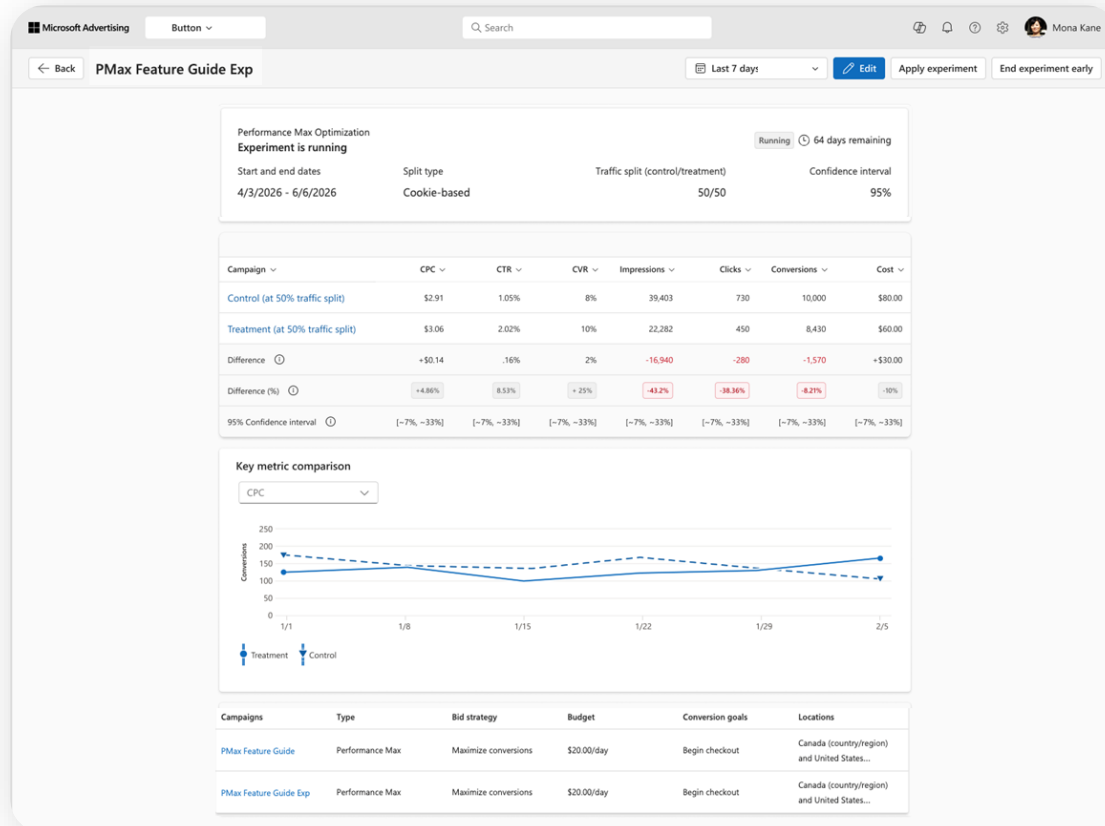
stocking stuffers for fitness lovers ✕
running shoes and apparel ✕

mens workout clothes ✕
womens activewear sets ✕
gym outfits for training ✕

performance workout gear ✕
breathable athletic clothing ✕

Type desired theme and press enter to add

Why optimization experiments?



Make evidence-based decisions

Use statistically significant results, not guesswork.

Minimize performance risk

Validate bidding, targeting, creative, and other campaign changes before scaling.

Act on results quickly

Apply winning experiments to your original or a new campaign in one click.

Optimization experiments best practices



Campaign selection

- Use high-volume campaigns, when possible, otherwise experiments may require longer experiment durations to reach statistical significance.
- Campaigns using shared or lifetime budgets are currently not supported.
- A campaign cannot participate in multiple experiments that will be active at the same time.



Traffic split

- Use a 50/50 traffic split to gather volume quickly and make comparisons easier.
- Experiment traffic split cannot be changed once an experiment is running.
- Results are automatically normalized so you can compare treatment (clicks, conversions, conversion value, cost, and impressions) and control fairly.



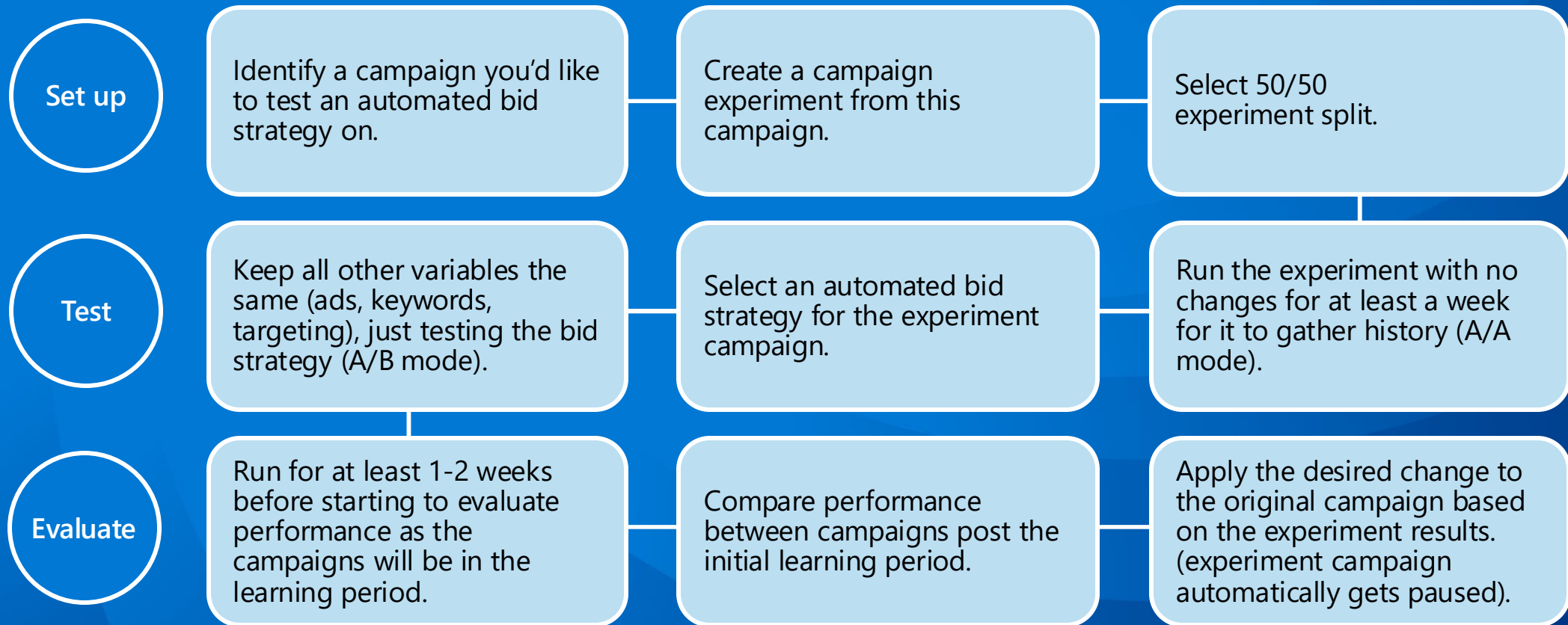
Experiment launch

- Test only one variable at a time.
- Switch to A/B mode for at least 2 weeks (ideally 4 weeks).

Setting up for success before peak periods with Automated Bidding

- 1 Test early and leverage Campaign Experiments to try new bid strategies.
- 2 Start with low-risk campaigns first, if implementing a new automated bidding strategy.
- 3 Set up selected strategies early to give time to collect ample data sets.
- 4 Ensure accuracy of your Universal Event Tracking (UET) tag and Conversion Tracking setup.
- 5 Set up Seasonality Adjustments.
- 6 Allow at least four weeks for new bidding strategies to stabilize.
- 7 If you add a new conversion goal ahead of holiday, wait at least four weeks before starting a new automated bidding strategy.

How to use Campaign Experiments for assessing the performance of a bid strategy



Best practices with seasonality adjustments

Campaigns using Seasonality adjustments will need to have stable performance with automated bidding and already completed their learning period.

Seasonality adjustments should not be used to address initial learning period fluctuation.

- You can create multiple adjustments targeting various campaigns or various time periods.
- If multiple adjustments target the same campaign, all adjustments will be applied.
- Seasonality adjustments can be applied to campaign experiments if both experiment and original campaigns are targeted.

USE CASES

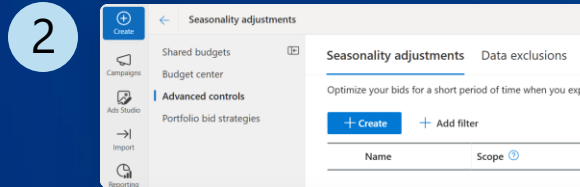
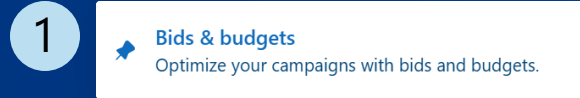


- Preparing for peak travel times during holidays to capture increased demand for booking flights in the weeks leading up and help re-adjust the days after the holiday travel peak.
- Getting setup for success in the days leading up to, during, and right after cyber week (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, etc.).

Set up & optimize seasonality adjustments

How to create

1. Go to Tools > Bids & Budgets
2. Open Advanced Controls > Seasonality Adjustments
3. Click Create to add a new adjustment
4. Enter a name (and optional description)
5. Set start and end time — range must be 14 days or less
6. Define scope and select devices
7. Define the conversion rate adjustment
8. Click Save to finalize



BEST PRACTICES

- Campaigns using seasonality adjustments need stable performance with automated bidding and a completed learning period.
- Do not use them to address initial learning period fluctuation.
- Create multiple adjustments targeting various campaigns or time periods; if several target the same campaign, all are applied.
- Can be applied to campaign experiments if both experiment and original campaigns are targeted.

USE CASES

- Preparing for peak travel times during holidays to capture increased demand for booking flights in the weeks leading up and help re-adjust the days after the holiday travel peak.
- Getting setup for success in the days leading up to, during, and right after cyber week (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, etc.).

Best practices to consider both in your prep and during peak days

- 1 Keep Automated Bidding strategies running as-is on key seasonal dates.
- 2 Ensure your campaigns are NOT limited by budget.
- 3 We don't recommend use of Max Cost Per Click (CPC) Caps.
- 4 Confirm Google Import settings if using the tool (one-time & recurring imports).

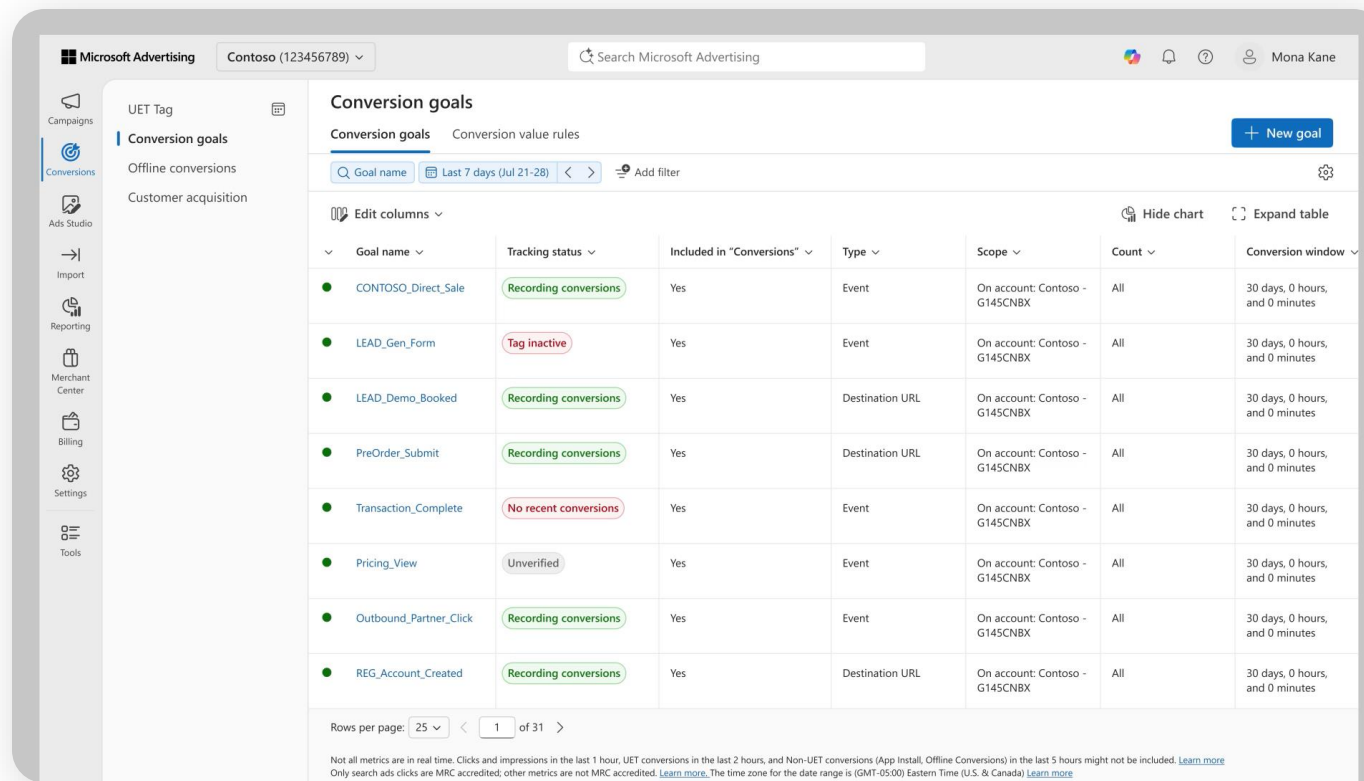
Validate your measurement foundation

Strong measurement drives stronger optimization. AI-powered bidding can only perform as well as the signals it receives.

Before holiday traffic ramps up, ensure tracking, goals, and first-party data are complete and accurate.

Audit UET implementation monthly and after major site updates. Incomplete or misfiring tags limit optimization.

- Validate tracking end-to-end from click through conversion reporting.
 - Copilot in MAP: Use a prompt like: *"Test my '[Conversion Goal Name]' goal and confirm if UET is configured correctly on my site."*
 - Use "Test This Goal" feature on conversion goal grid; hover over the tracking status column and a pop up will appear for test this goal.

Goal name	Tracking status	Included in "Conversions"	Type	Scope	Count	Conversion window
CONTOSO_Direct_Sale	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Gen_Form	Tag inactive	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Demo_Booked	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
PreOrder_Submit	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Transaction_Complete	No recent conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Pricing_View	Unverified	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Outbound_Partner_Click	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
REG_Account_Created	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes

Rows per page: 25 of 31

Not all metrics are in real time. Clicks and Impressions in the last 1 hour. UET conversions in the last 2 hours, and Non-UET conversions (App Install, Offline Conversions) in the last 5 hours might not be included. [Learn more](#)
Only search ads clicks are MRC accredited; other metrics are not MRC accredited. [Learn more](#). The time zone for the date range is (GMT-05:00) Eastern Time (U.S. & Canada) [Learn more](#)

Strengthen optimization signals

Stronger signals drive stronger optimization. Automated bidding learns fastest when it receives complete, high-quality data.

Strengthen these signals before holiday demand peaks so bidding can optimize with confidence.

Data sources provide signals that help systems learn faster, optimize more effectively, and drive better results.

- **Connect first-party data sources** with the Conversions API across online, website, offline, CRM, and app systems before the holiday season.
- **Track high-intent, mid-funnel actions** to give bidding earlier signals on likely converters and accelerate learning. Use these as secondary goals for insight, while keeping primary optimization on your most important outcome, such as purchases.
- **Pass conversion values whenever possible.** Revenue value ensures you optimize for value, not just volume.

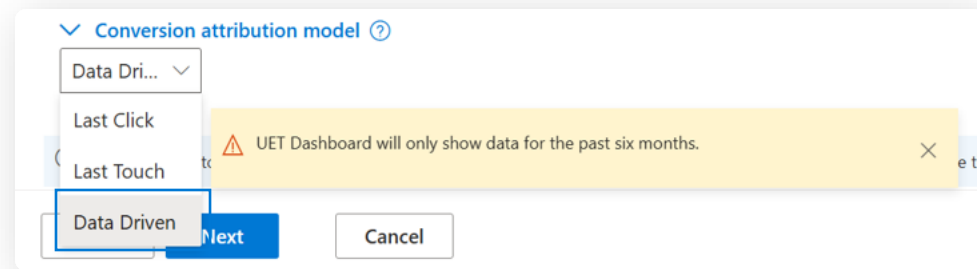
Data-driven attribution

Move beyond last-click attribution to better reflect how customers actually convert across the full journey.

Data-driven attribution helps bidding optimize toward the touchpoints that truly drive performance.

Consider updating your attribution model from last-click to Data-driven.

- **Distribute credit across the full journey** — switch to Data-driven Attribution (DDA) so conversion credit reflects the entire path, not just the final interaction
- **Confirm eligibility** — available for campaigns running conversion-based bid strategies (including Enhanced CPC) with large conversion volume (200+ conversions in 30 days).



Microsoft Clarity

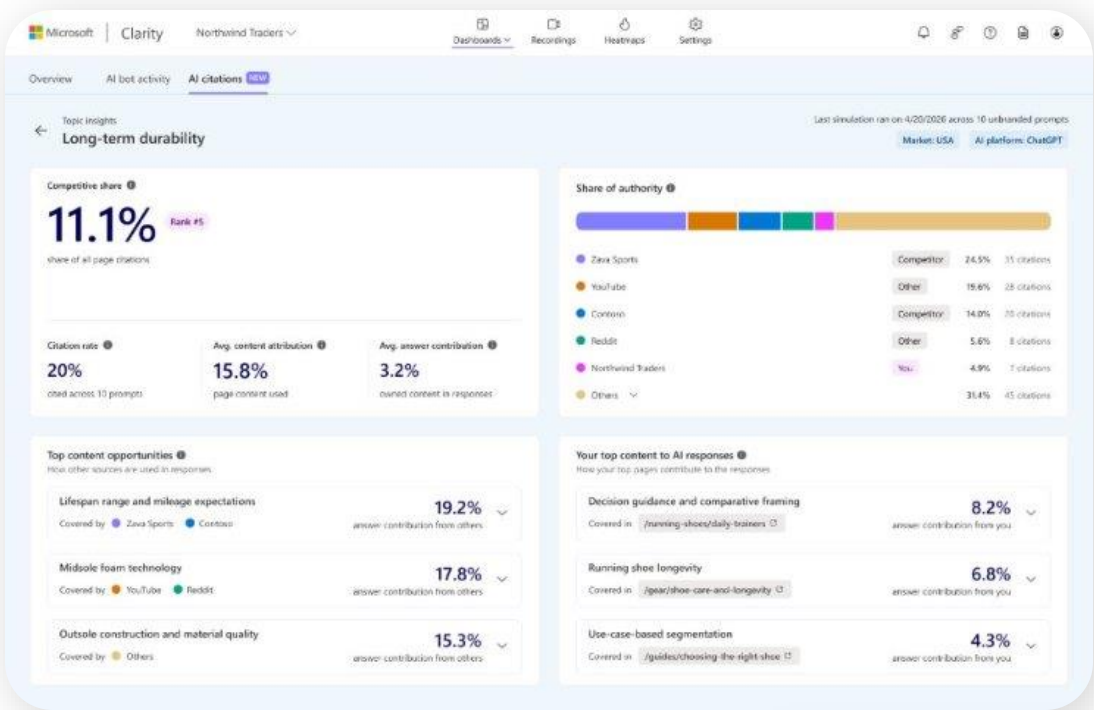
From AI discovery to on-site conversion

Clarity helps you understand how you're discovered in AI, what to improve, and how shoppers behave after the click.

- **Get discovered in AI**
Most analytics can't see how AI surfaces your brand. Clarity tracks it.
- **Know what to improve**
Page views tell you "what," not "why." Clarity recommends how to lift visibility.
- **Win after the click**
Rage-clicks and drop-offs stay hidden. Clarity reveals on-site behavior to optimize.

Set up Clarity now to baseline your AI discovery before peak season
→ clarity.microsoft.com

Clarity AI visibility



Discovery: Bot activity

Track how AI crawlers and answer engines discover your site.

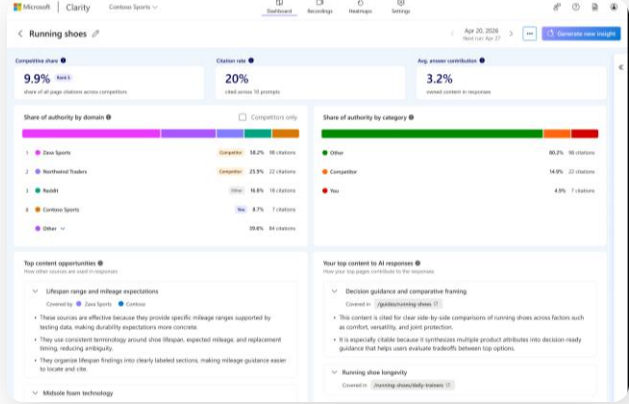
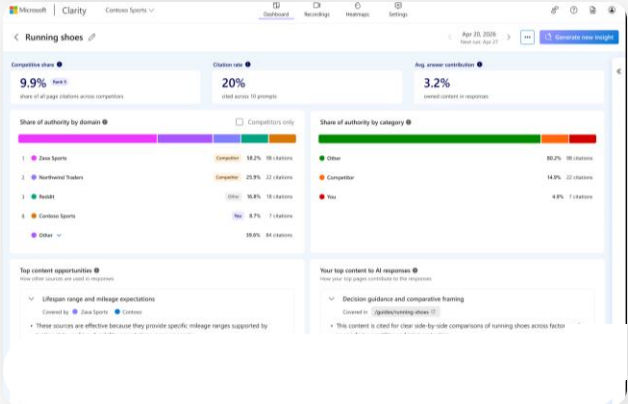
Visibility: Citations and share of authority

See where your brand appears in AI answers, which topics you show up for, and how you compare to your competitors.

Impact: Trends and outcomes

Track visibility trends over time and get content recommendations to improve AI selection and business outcomes.

Query		SoA	Citations
1 northwind casual shoes	Branded	18.00%	7.00K
2 performance soccer shoes for athletes	Non-branded	20.50%	6.10K
3 walking shoes	Non-branded	19.00%	5.90K
4 professional tennis shoes for tournaments	Non-branded	27.50%	5.50K
5 northwind running shoes	Branded	30.00%	4.80K
6 northwind crossfit shoes	Branded	32.00%	4.50K
7 northwind slip-on shoes	Branded	17.50%	4.30K



MICROSOFT CLARITY

BEHAVIOR ANALYTICS

See what happens after they land

Whether traffic comes from AI, search, or ads.

Session recordings

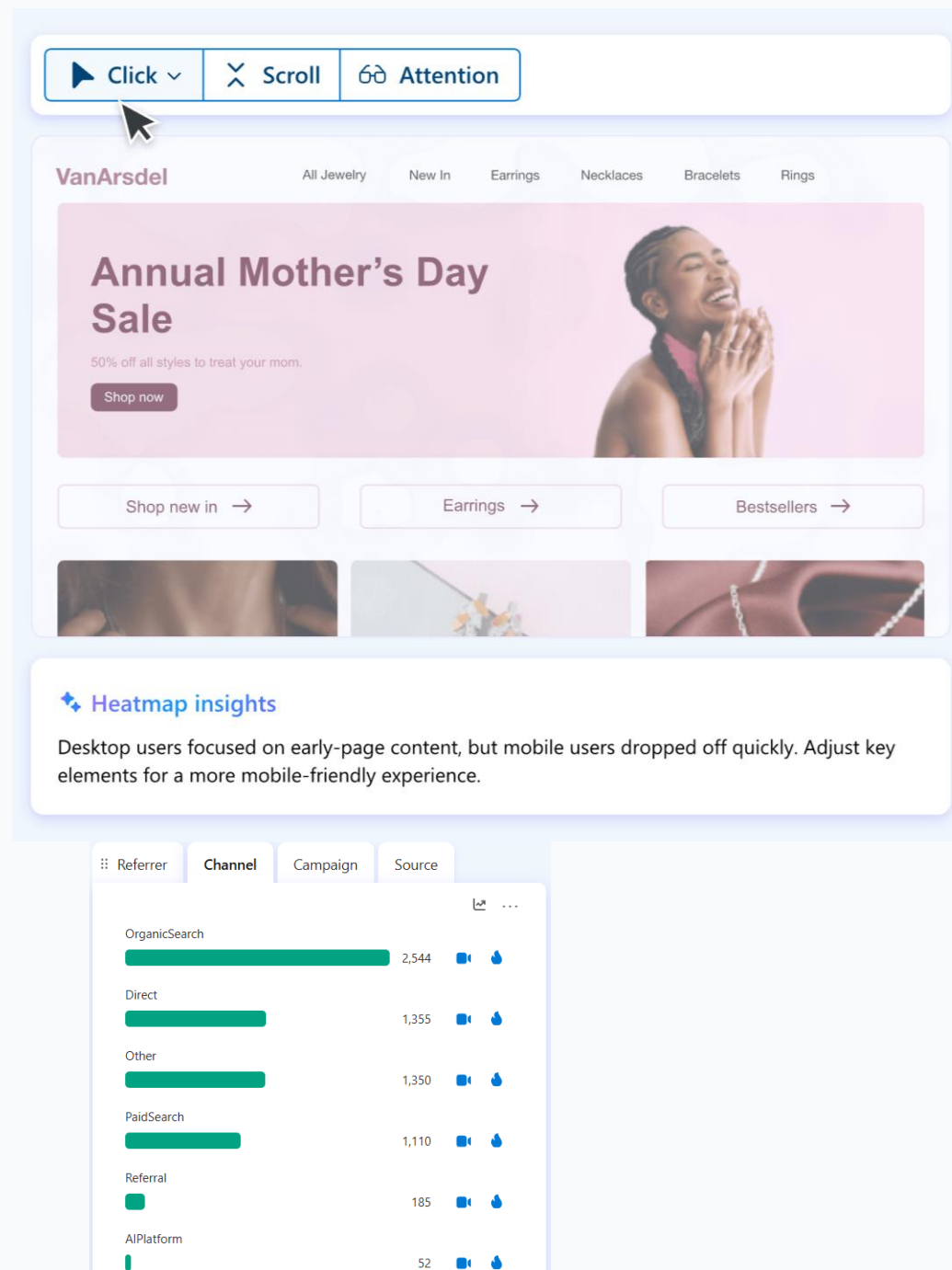
Watch real visits with rage-click and dead-click flags

Heatmaps

See where attention goes and where it drops off

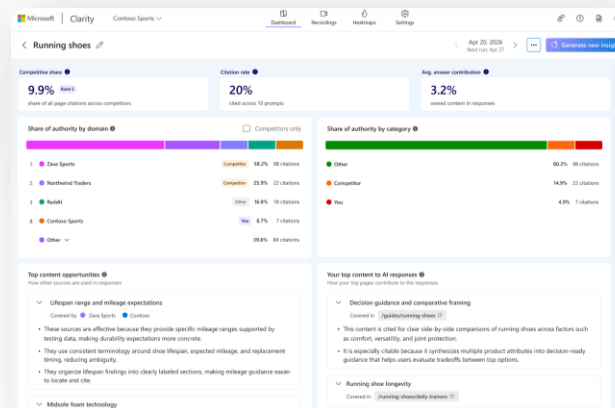
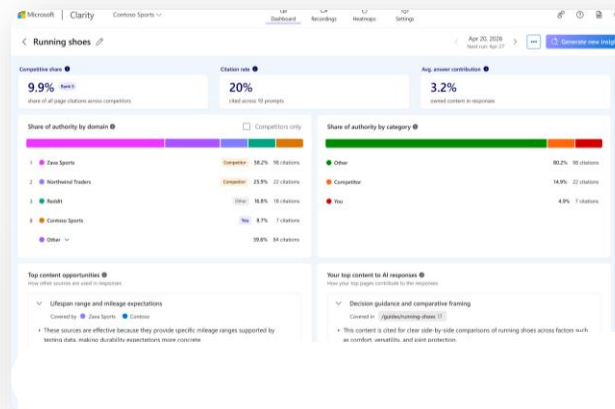
Smart Events

Auto-detect signups, purchases, downloads, and errors



AI visibility

	Query		SoA	Citations
1	northwind casual shoes	Branded	18.00%	7.00K
2	performance soccer shoes for athletes	Non-branded	20.50%	6.10K
3	walking shoes	Non-branded	19.00%	5.90K
4	professional tennis shoes for tournaments	Non-branded	27.50%	5.50K
5	northwind running shoes	Branded	30.00%	4.80K
6	northwind crossfit shoes	Branded	32.00%	4.50K
7	northwind slip-on shoes	Branded	17.50%	4.30K



Discovery: bot activity

Understand how AI systems discover your site by tracking bot activity across AI crawlers and answer engines.

Visibility: citations and share of authority

See where your brand appears in AI answers, which topics you show up for, and how you compare to others.

Impact: trends and outcomes

Track visibility trends over time and get content recommendations to improve AI selection and business outcomes.

Phase 2: Gift Them A Reason



Phase 02 Gift them a reason

– September / October

Gift them a Reason

Create Demand

- Expand reach and increase visibility ahead of peak shopping moments
- Connect with **untapped audiences** through:
 - **LinkedIn Profile Targeting**
 - **Seasonal in-market audiences**
 - **New customer acquisition** strategies
- Influence shoppers earlier in their decision-making journey with **Impression-based remarketing**

Optimize for Seasonal Relevance

- **Refresh creative** and promotional messaging to align with holiday trends
- Adjust campaigns to **capitalize on seasonal demand shifts**
- Maintain relevance throughout the shopping season

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 2: Engage during peak season

Driving awareness, consideration, and customer engagement



"Search is enough."

"Creative doesn't matter during the holidays."

"We should focus only on existing customers."

- Shoppers engage across multiple channels before converting, and AI Max, Performance Max, Shopping, and Audience Ads help create, expand, and capture demand along the journey.
- Seasonal messaging, offers, and urgency can significantly impact performance.
- Holiday growth often attracts new shoppers earlier in the buying journey, making upper-funnel engagement a key driver of conversions before the final click.
- The holiday season is one of the biggest opportunities to acquire new customers.

The average Holiday conversion journey is 52 days

Strong visibility throughout the **full season** is critical to engaging and re-engaging holiday shoppers.

- ✓ Create awareness early with upper funnel Audience Ad tactics.
- ✓ Build and target robust remarketing lists to re-engage consumers, during and post Cyber-5.



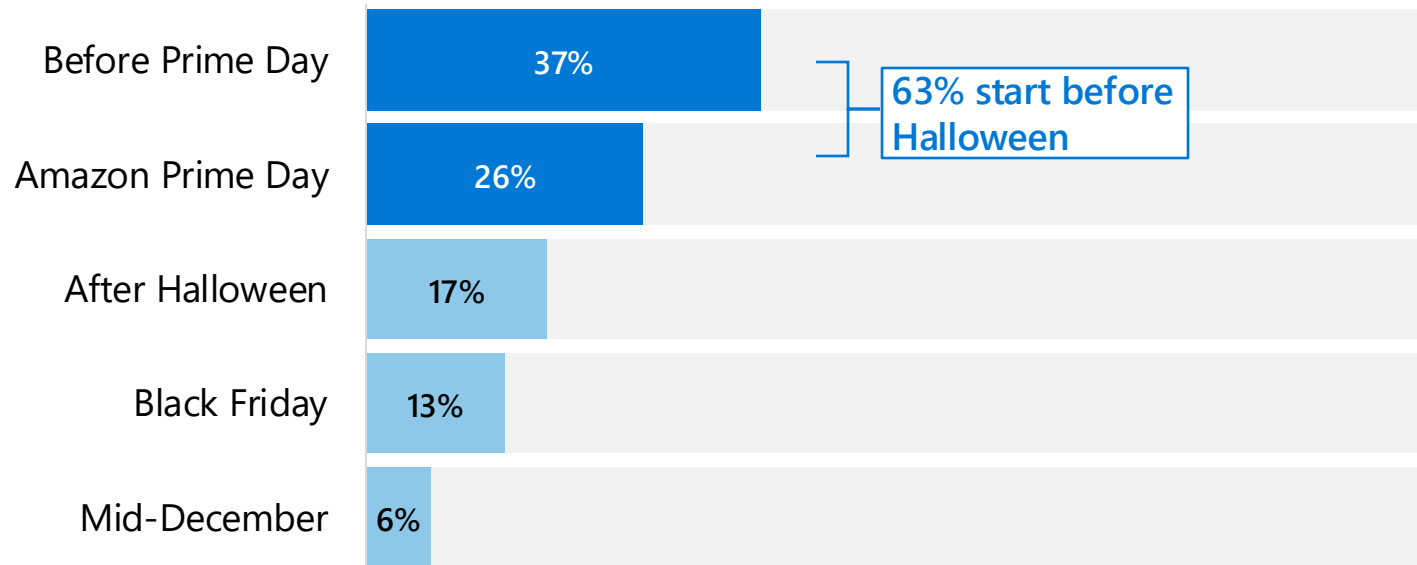


Oct Prime Day starts holiday shopping for many consumers

Have holiday messaging, product feeds, budgets, and full-funnel coverage ready ahead of October Prime Day to capture early intent

When Holiday shoppers plan to start

Share of Respondents



63% start before Halloween
Earlier shopping windows mean early-season demand matters.

Late-season starts still concentrates around Black Friday and December but represents a much smaller share than early-season starters.

During the peak days, monitor and optimize closely

1

If using Enhanced CPC, continuously optimize base bids as one of most important levers

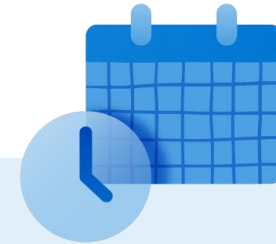
2

For TCPA/TROAS, make Target and Budget changes as needed. There is no constraint on the frequency of target changes.

3

Set conversion value rules towards your performance goals

Develop audience strategies early



- Build audience lists early to ensure sufficient scale before peak.
- Separate prospecting and retargeting into distinct campaigns so you can tailor bids and messaging.
- Use In-Market and Similar Audiences for acquisition and prospecting.
- Use Remarketing, Dynamic Remarketing, and Customer Match for re-engagement and personalized offers.
- Use Impression-Based Remarketing to build audience lists from ad exposure.
- Activate seasonal audiences such as Black Friday and Christmas segments.

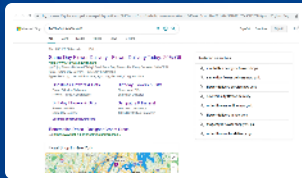
Re-engage audiences with impression-based remarketing

Target people who've seen your ads, even if they haven't clicked, with sequential messaging that guides them from initial interest to conversion.

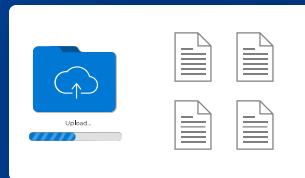
Shoppers who start their journey exposed to an Audience Ad convert 6% more often throughout the season.



Olivia is in-market for a holiday gift...



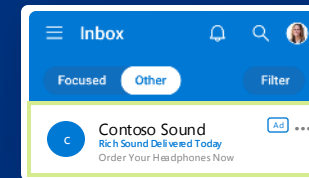
Olivia is searching on Bing for wireless earbuds. She sees your ad, but clicks on a competitor.



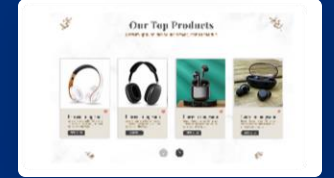
Olivia is placed in your impression-based remarketing list.



The next day, she visits MSN and sees your ad, keeping your brand top of mind.



Later, while checking emails, she sees your ad, clicks, and visits your site.

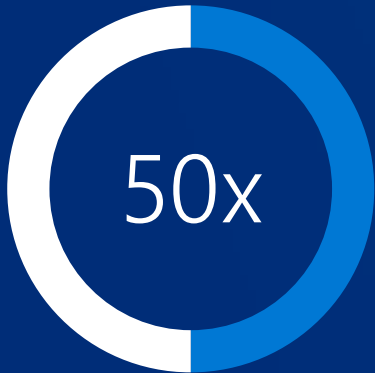


Olivia chooses to buy wireless earbuds from your company and checks out on your site.

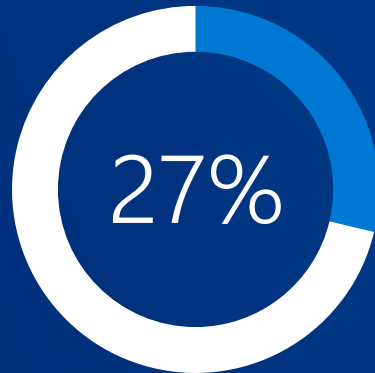
s.Oliver Case Study

By combining festive storytelling with impression-based remarketing, s.Oliver turned passive ad viewers into active customers.

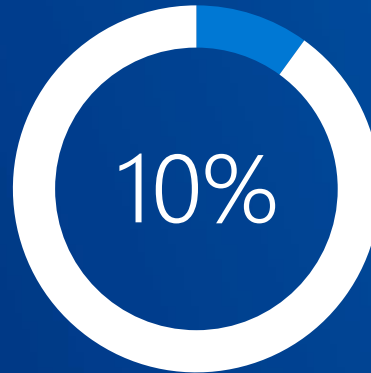
Impression-based remarketing helped this German retailer to achieve:



50x higher CTR compared to other video platforms.



27% conversion rate for impression-based remarketing lists.



10% lower CPM compared to other video platforms.



"Impression-based remarketing lists have helped us to clearly connect the reach in the upper funnel with the performance in the lower funnel!"

This is why Microsoft Advertising's full-funnel solutions are now a cornerstone of our brand strategy".

Christoph Bornkessel

Head of Brand Strategy,
Media & Digital Marketing,
s.Oliver

Read more here:
[s.Oliver | Microsoft Advertising](#)



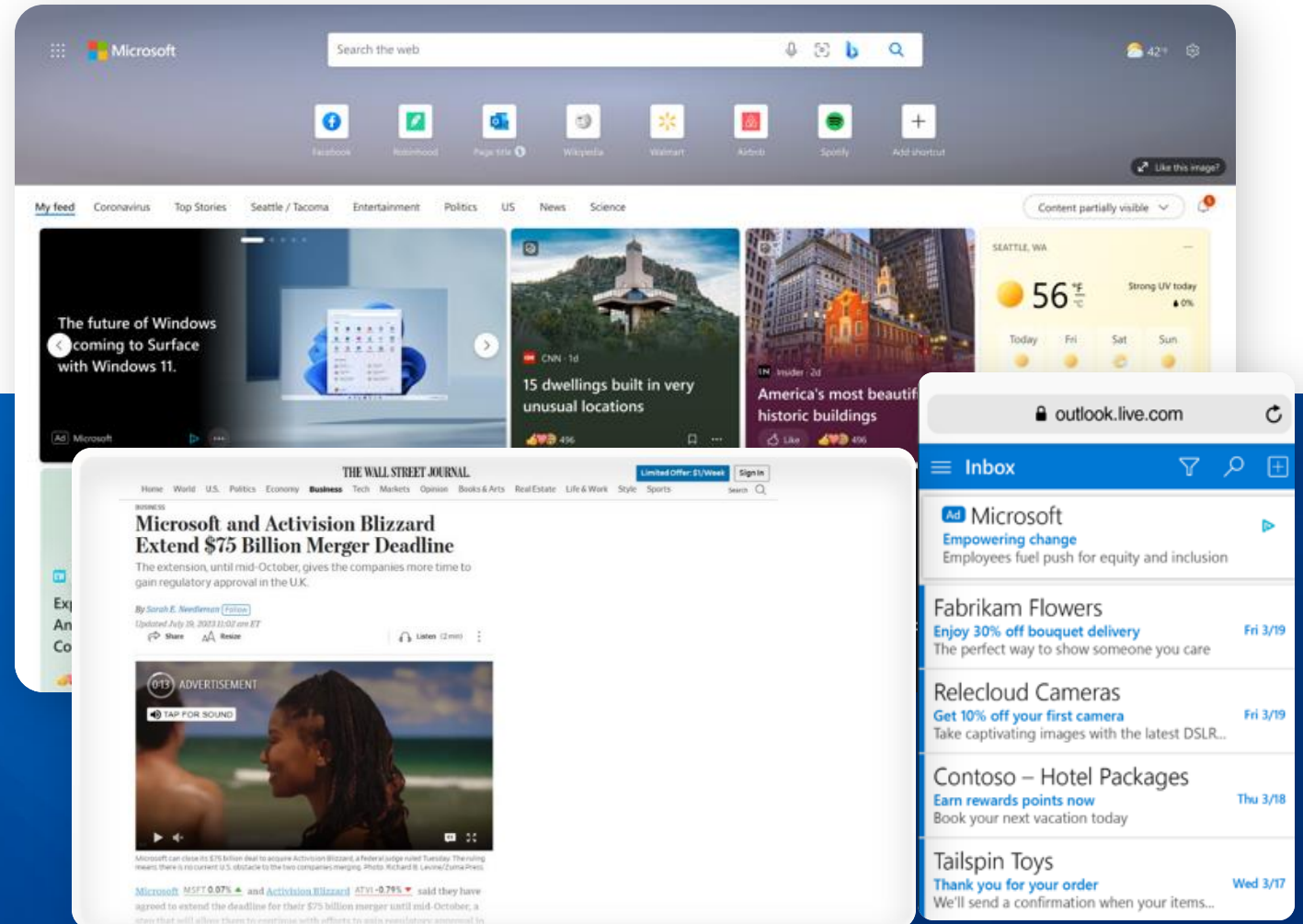
Drive higher engagement in contextually relevant environments

Placement targeting

Exclusively serve ads on premium Microsoft properties such as MSN, Outlook, Microsoft Casual Games, King games and more

Topic targeting

Pinpoint specific topics that align with your brand and audience to ensure your ads appear on sites with contextually relevant content



Placement targeting bundles

Choose the placement targeting bundles that best align with your goals

Placement bundle	Publishers	Ad formats	Devices
Microsoft Edge	Microsoft Edge (new tab page)	Native	Desktop
MSN	MSN (all ad placements on MSN)	Native, display, online video	Desktop, mobile, tablet
MSN - Health	MSN Health (all MSN health ad placements*)	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
MSN - Money	MSN Money (all MSN money/finance ad placements)	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
Productivity	Outlook	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
Gaming	Microsoft Casual Games	Display, online video	Desktop, mobile, tablet
	MSN Gaming	Native, display	Desktop
	King (e.g. Candy Crush Saga)	Online video	Mobile

Choose the topics that align with your customers' interests

Arts & Entertainment

Autos & Vehicles

Beauty & Fitness

Books & Literature

Business & Industrial

Computers & Electronics

Finance

Food & Drink

Games

Health

Hobbies & Leisure

Home & Garden

Internet & Telecom

Jobs & Education

Law & Government

News

Online Communities

People & Society

Pets & Animals

Real Estate

Reference

Science

Shopping

Sports

Travel

Transportation

World Localities

Seasonal in-market audiences

Seasonal segments are lists of people ready to buy for a particular event, like Black Friday or Christmas.

Seasonal segments use the same audience intelligence as existing In-market audience segments, and are infused with additional signals related to the seasonal event to deliver a relevant user segment of likely converters.

Black Friday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/in-store Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/online Black Friday shopping.

Christmas holiday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/after-Christmas sale shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/in-store Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/online Christmas shopping

Cyber-5 generates 9% of holiday conversions with just 7% of clicks as shoppers are highly engaged and ready to purchase.



LOOKFANTASTIC

Turns beauty trends into cart conversions



The challenge

- Traditionally relied on lower-funnel Search campaigns to capture existing demand
- Needed to engage beauty shoppers earlier in the purchase journey amid intense competition

The objective

- Determine whether upper-funnel media investment could drive measurable business outcomes beyond awareness

The solution

- **Build attention at scale and reinforce the message using [Audience ads](#):** The team could reach beauty shoppers while competitors focused heavily on search. Image-led Native formats kept their brand top of mind.
- **Turn views into action through [impression-based remarketing](#):** The strategy reconnected users who had seen ads and re-engaged them through Search when they were ready to buy.
- **Activate high-intent signals using Microsoft [in-market audiences](#):** First-party data and customer match layering helped balance prospecting and re-engagement with in-market audiences.

The results

2.7x

Conversion lift from in-market audiences

76%

Video view-through rate

56%

Revenue generated from remarketing

Refine your assets for holiday with Ads Studio

- Enter a prompt to describe what your campaign and target audience to help Copilot generate asset themes.
- You can choose from one or multiple themes.
- You can also rewrite copy with a given holiday prompt.
 - Find similar short headlines
 - Try a different tone
 - Revise

Refine your asset recommendations

Select **Refine** to get updated recommendations by providing new descriptions or select **Remove assets** to remove all assets from the current asset group.

Refine

Remove assets

Get asset recommendations



Final URL: <https://www.contoso.com/>

Provide a description of your product.

 Microsoft Advertising will use the descriptions that you provide to generate new asset recommendations. If your description doesn't match your website's content, we'll generate recommendations entirely from your Final URL.

Highlight what you'd like to include in your ads.

0 / 300



Choose the themes you'd like to add to your asset group. 



Apply

Cancel

Creative best practices

Minimum images needed for asset groups

At least one image with 1.91:1 ratio and one image with 1:1 ratio

Choose **compelling images**. No **text** overlays

Leverage the **Ad Preview tool** for aspect ratios

Turn on **auto-generated assets** to improve performance

Leverage **Assets reporting** for optimization

Customize assets background based on campaign structure and audience signals with **Copilot** in Microsoft Advertising Platform

Holiday example and best practices for prompting AI

Subject A digital camera

Point of view

Primary Setting Placed on a soft white blanket

Secondary Props with gift boxes next to it

Tertiary Atmosphere with snowflake lights behind it
with a Christmas atmosphere

CHRISTMAS ATMOSPHERE



HALLOWEEN SCENE



LUNAR NEW YEAR

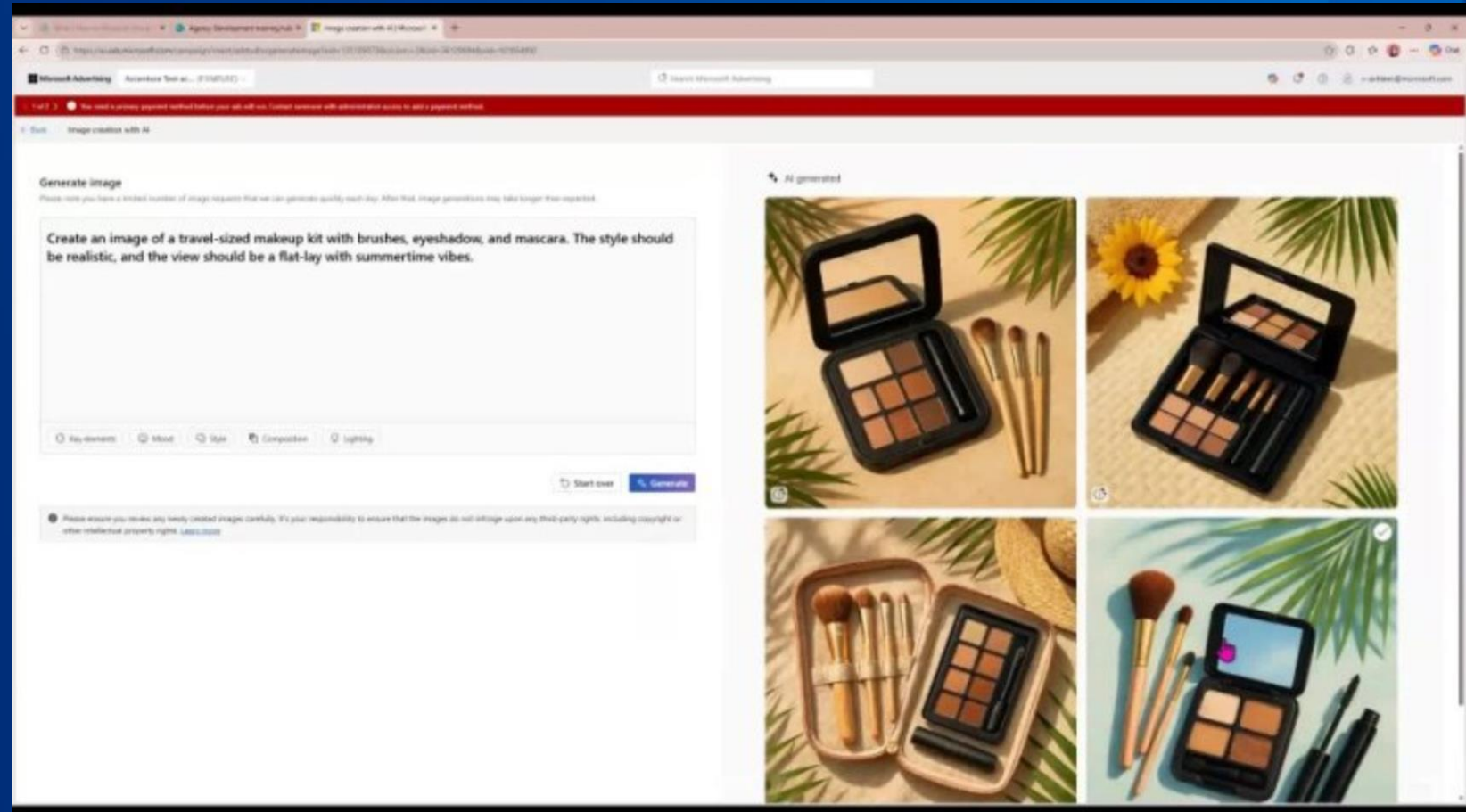


VALENTINE'S DAY SCENE



Create a background and image with AI

- Type in a text prompt to generate a new background
- Hover over example images to see example prompts
- Click **Apply background** to add to your library. Saved as a copy to your original image.



Phase 3: Ring in the Sales!



Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 3: Ring in the Sales!

When shoppers are ready to buy



"The competitive landscape is static throughout the season."

"Shopping campaigns don't need optimization."

"There are so many shoppers, promotions aren't necessary."

- Feed quality, product titles, images, offers, and pricing all can impact performance.
- Holiday demand doesn't guarantee sales. Consumers are actively comparing prices, deals, and brands. Promotions, seasonal messaging, and compelling offers can help capture attention, improve conversion rates, and maximize your share of holiday demand.

Phase 03 Ring in the sales – November / December

Capture Demand at Peak Moments

- Ensure campaigns are **fully optimized** and ready to scale
- Maximize reach and efficiency with **Performance Max** and **AI Max**
- Schedule **promotions** in advance to support key shopping events
- Maintain **sufficient budget headroom** to capture rising demand

Stay Agile Throughout the Season

- **Refresh creative assets** regularly to prevent fatigue
- **Evolve audience strategies** as shopper behavior changes
- Monitor performance daily to **identify optimization opportunities**

October clicks fuel conversions well into the holiday season

Among nearly 500K holiday user paths, October was a key starting point as **56% of November conversions** and **35% of December conversions** originated from October clicks.

October was the starting point for **56% of November** and **35% of December conversions**.

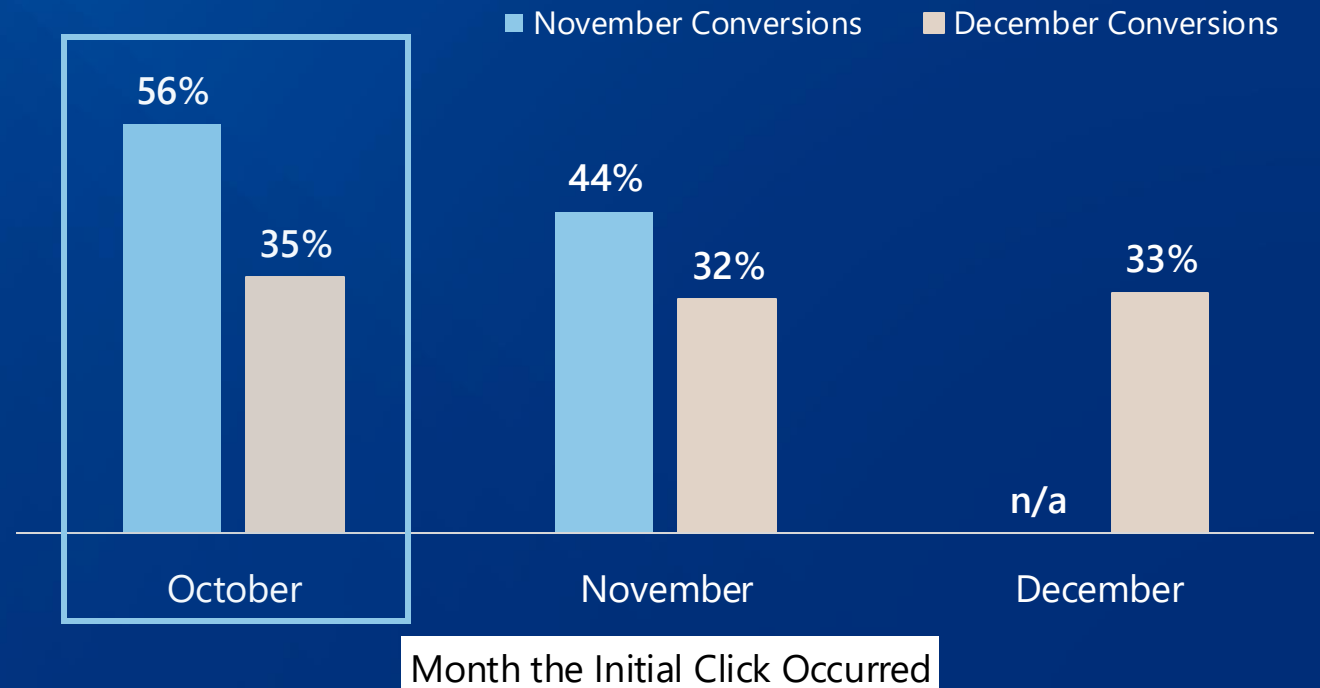
56%

Nov Conv

35%

Dec Conv

- ✓ Use October to drive more cost-efficient site traffic, build remarketing lists, and re-engage high-intent shoppers in November and December.





Sales events are now the default

As shopping becomes more event-led, these key moments are becoming essential drivers of growth

82% 

of respondents
shopped a sales event
last year.

87% 

of respondents
plan to shop a sales event
this year.

- ✓ Plan for always-on coverage with PMax to maintain presence before, during, and after events, to capture both early planners and last-minute shoppers.

Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist – Phase 3

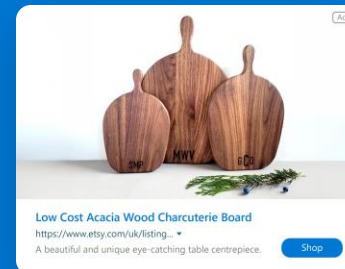
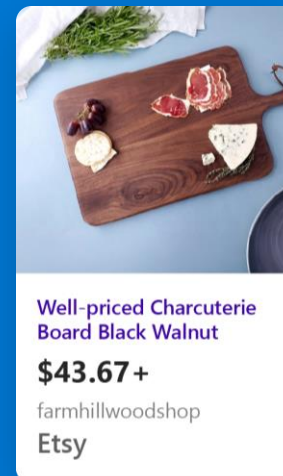
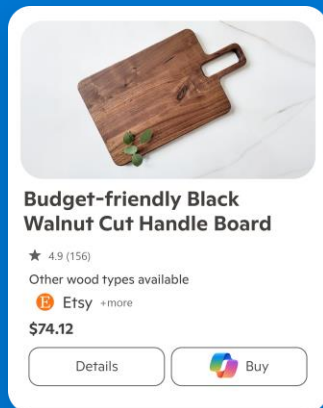
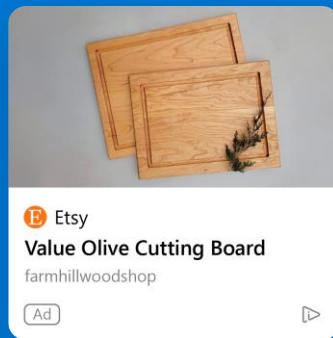


Pro tip: Use Product explorer in Merchant Center to easily view all products in your catalog, audit, and identify issues.

Highlight holiday shopping details, deals, and incentives.

- ☐ **Sale prices**
Show your discounted price
- ☐ **Pricing accuracy**
Keep pricing and availability accurate in real time.
- ☐ **Merchant promotions**
Offer shopping incentives like buy 1 get 1 free, discount codes, \$20 off \$100, etc.
- ☐ **Local Inventory ads**
Show local inventory availability
- ☐ **Curbside pickup**
- ☐ **Free Shipping**
- ☐ **Monitor feed health**
Audit the feed for disapprovals and missing attributes daily through peak
- ☐ **Additional images**
Show shoppers multiple product views.

AI-powered Performance Max helps you drive more conversions across Microsoft properties and formats



+8%
increase in incremental
conversions

Performance Max for short-term promotions

SET UP FOR SUCCESS

- **Use an existing account:** For a fast ramp, a separate campaign is preferred, since you can't weight "holiday" asset groups.
- **Verify conversion tracking** with an existing goal (2+ weeks of history) and upload offline conversions regularly.
- **Keep your feed healthy:** (valid GTINs, correct pricing) and allow a 72-hour feed ramp.
- **Launch new assets early:** Upload paused 48 hours ahead for editorial, then activate as early as possible (up to a 1-day ramp).
- **Refresh Customer Match lists:** These take up to 24 hours to process — refresh them ahead of key moments.

MAXIMIZE PEAK DEMAND

- **Add more budget** so campaigns aren't budget-constrained and can capture incremental traffic.
- **Search themes are a must:** Add diverse, top-volume queries from search term insights, plus new products and promotions.
- **Seasonal in-market audiences:** Target Black Friday, Christmas holiday, and more.
- **Seasonality adjustments & value rules:** Leverage both to guide bidding.

No conversion goals? Use other campaign types (search, audience) with Maximize Clicks or Enhanced CPC, plus merchant promotions, promotion and price extensions, sitelinks, callouts, image extensions, and countdown customizers.

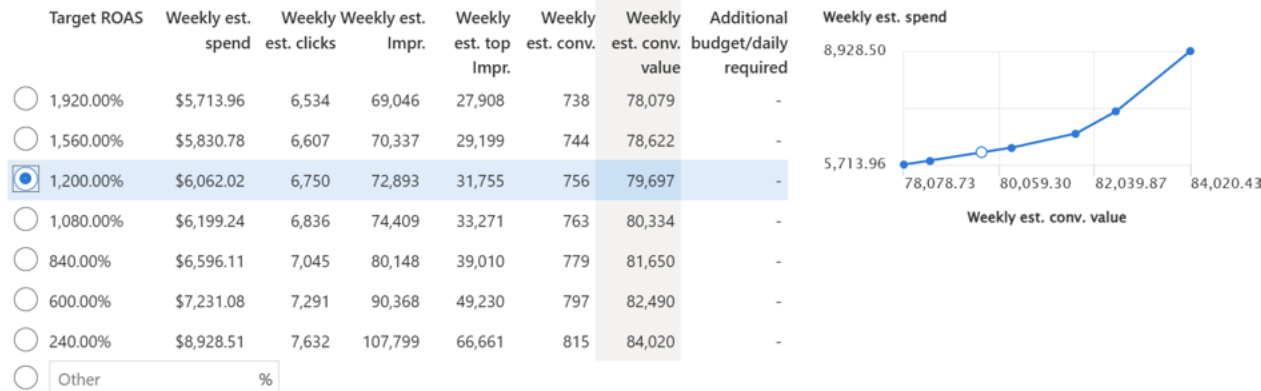
Target and budget considerations

Leverage the bid landscape tool

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different targets.

Campaign bid landscape

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different Target ROAS. [Learn more](#)



Apply to my campaign

Cancel

*This simulation is based on performance from 11/25/2024 to 12/1/2024. These are estimated figures and do not guarantee future results.

Black Friday and Cyber Monday fall at month-end — monitor budget pacing so you aren't constrained in the peak moments.

Reminder: Avoid capping your budgets

Hitting your budget caps should be avoided; it is better to use **targets** to control spend.

Conversion value rules

Better express the value of conversions as they relate to your business

Conversion value rules allow you to adjust your conversion values if the conversion meets certain conditions (or rules) that may be relevant to your business goals. You can set conditions for **locations**, **devices**, and **audiences**.

Example:

Let me choose specific locations

Search for location

Enter a location to target or exclude

For example, the US, a state, coordinates in the US, or a ZIP code.

Targeted locations

- Within New York, New York, United States

Excluded locations

- Within Brooklyn, New York, United States

For locations you want to include, adjust values for

- ☒ People in your targeted locations
- ☐ People searching for or viewing pages about your targeted locations

For locations you want to exclude, adjust values for

- ☐ People in your targeted locations
- ☒ People searching for or viewing pages about your targeted locations

Value adjustment ⓘ

Add 2

Add

Multiply

Conversion value rule preview

If Location: New York, ...

And Audience: All audiences

Then Multiply 5.5

Optimize your true business goals

Better reflect your business' data and optimize to what matters, like revenue or lifetime value.

Simplified management

Enhance reporting and optimization directly from your Microsoft account, without having to change any tagging code.

Control your message

Conversion value rules allow you to optimize for nuanced values in real-time with conversion-based automated bidding strategies (Target ROAS and Maximize Conversion Value only)

Note: Currently only supported at the account level, not campaign level

Currently does not support store visit goals

New Customer Acquisition

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789)

New performance max campaign

Assets Targeting Campaign details Budget Summary

How much do you want to spend?

Tell us about your campaign and how much you want to spend

Bid strategy

Which bid strategy do you want to use to manage your daily budget?

Maximize conversions

Using the Maximize conversions bid strategy to help you get the most conversions for your budget.

☐ Set a target cost per action

Optimize new customer acquisition

Optimization strategy for new customers

☐ Bid higher for new customers

☒ Bid only for new customers

Existing customer segments

Segment A Segment B Segment C

Edit customer acquisition

Budget

These are estimates based on businesses with similar ad settings and budget.

Option	Monthly conversions	CTR
Advanced	130 - 145	3%
	Monthly impressions	Monthly clicks

\$45/day | \$1,350/month

BID UP FOR NEW CUSTOMERS ONLY, keep the same for existing customers

NEED TO KNOW/DO

- Set Maximize conversion value as your bid strategy.
- Target ROAS is optional.
- Create a Purchase conversion goal at the account level.

RECOMMENDED IF YOU WANT TO

- Maintain your scale and engagement with potential returning customers
- Have a higher conversion value set for new customers

TARGET AND BID ONLY FOR NEW CUSTOMERS

NEED TO KNOW/DO

- Optimize your bids to target new customers exclusively.
- Your audience list will help us optimize for targeting only new customers during ad delivery. This the audience we are excluding.

RECOMMENDED IF YOU HAVE:

- Strict budgets or creative assets for new users vs. returning users
- Non-purchase conversion goals like lead generation.
- Another PMax campaign for all customers.

Setup guide

Option 1:

During Performance Max campaign creation/editing:

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789)

New performance max campaign

Assets
Targeting
Campaign details
Budget
Summary

How much do you want to spend?
Tell us about your campaign and how much you want to spend

Bid strategy

Which bid strategy do you want to use to manage your daily budget?

Maximize conversions

Using the Maximize conversions bid strategy to help you get the most conversions for your budget.

☐ Set a target cost per action

☒ **Optimize new customer acquisition**

Optimization strategy for new customers

☐ Bid higher for new customers

☒ Bid only for new customers

Existing customer segments

Segment A Segment B Segment C

Edit customer acquisition

Option 2:

From the Conversion goals page:

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789) Search

Conversion goals

UET tag
Conversion goals
Offline conversions
Customer acquisition

Customer acquisition

About customer acquisition

Customer acquisition involves prioritizing new customers

+ Create

Goal name	Type	Existing

Optimize your campaign to target new customers on PMax

Option 1

Increase bids for new customers: This increases your bids for new customers while continuing to bid for existing customers. If you choose this option, you must:

Set Maximize conversion value as your bid strategy.

Target ROAS is optional.

Create a Purchase conversion goal at the account level.

Option 2

Target and bid only for new customers: This optimizes your bids to target new customers exclusively.

Your audience list will help us optimize for targeting only new customers during ad delivery.

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789)

New performance max campaign

How much do you want to spend?
Tell us about your campaign and how much you want to spend

Bid strategy

Which bid strategy do you want to use to manage your daily budget? *

Maximize conversions

Using the Maximize conversions bid strategy to help you get the most conversions for your budget.

Set a target cost per action

Optimize new customer acquisition

Optimization strategy for new customers

Bid higher for new customers

Bid only for new customers

Existing customer segments *

Segment A Segment B Segment C

Edit customer acquisition

Budget

These are estimates based on businesses with similar ad settings and budget.

Advanced

\$45/day | \$1,350/month

Monthly conversions 130 - 145

CTR 3%

Monthly impressions

Monthly clicks

Setup guide

Option 1:

During Performance Max campaign creation/editing:

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New performance max campaign

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Budget
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How much do you want to spend?
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☐ Set a target cost per action

☒ **Optimize new customer acquisition**

Optimization strategy for new customers

☐ Bid higher for new customers

☒ **Bid only for new customers**

Existing customer segments

Segment A Segment B Segment C

Edit customer acquisition

Option 2:

From the Conversion goals page:

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789) Search

Conversion goals

UET tag
Conversion goals
Offline conversions
Customer acquisition

Customer acquisition

About customer acquisition
Customer acquisition involves prioritizing new customers

+ Create

Goal name	Type	Existing conversions

Choosing the conversion value and your audience lists

- 1 Enter the Conversion value for new customers and optionally add an audience list.

This will then be the audiences of existing customers that the campaign will **not** bid higher for or target

Set up new customer acquisition

Conversion value for new customer

Enter the target amount you want to pay for a new customer's purchase of your product or service. *Note:* The final value will be based on the target amount you enter here plus the default purchase value set in your **Purchase** conversion goal.

\$ 25

Existing audience list

Add an audience list to help us identify potential new customers. *Note:* You can update your audience lists in [Audiences](#).

Search in your audience segments

0 segment

Existing audience lists

Add an audience list to help us identify potential new customers. *Note:* You can update your audience lists in [Audiences](#).

Search in your audience segments

- ☒ Test remarketing
- ☐ test dyna remarketing
- ☐ Test
- ☐ test customer match list

- If you choose Bid only for new customers, you must add at least one audience list.
- These audiences are lists you want to essentially EXCLUDE.
- Refresh audience lists often.

Best practices on setting a conversion value for new customer (only used for bidding up within current campaign)

Let's reflect: how much more valuable is a new customer vs. a returning one?



Pro Tip: ideally, setting an additional revenue value that's **at least 30% of the average revenue** you see from a usual sale is best to help the campaign optimize towards new customers.

Set up new customer acquisition

Conversion value for new customer

Enter the target amount you want to pay for a new customer's purchase of your product or service. *Note:* The final value will be based on the target amount you enter here plus the default purchase value set in your Purchase conversion goal.

\$ 25

Online printing company example:

01

AOV last 30 days:
\$167

02

30% of AOV:
\$50

03

Set my NCA value to
\$50 for new customers

Note: Even if it's an estimate, inputting a higher value will help signal the algorithm that you value new customers more than existing ones. **The final value will be based on the target you enter PLUS the default purchase value set in your conversion goal.**

Consider offering "first order promotions" in ad copy to entice new customers.

So which adventure do I choose?

Bid UP within my current campaign

Recommended if you want to:

- Prioritize bidding towards new customers
- Maintain your scale and engagement with potential returning customers
- Ensure you have a higher conversion value set for new customers

Setting up a separate NCA campaign

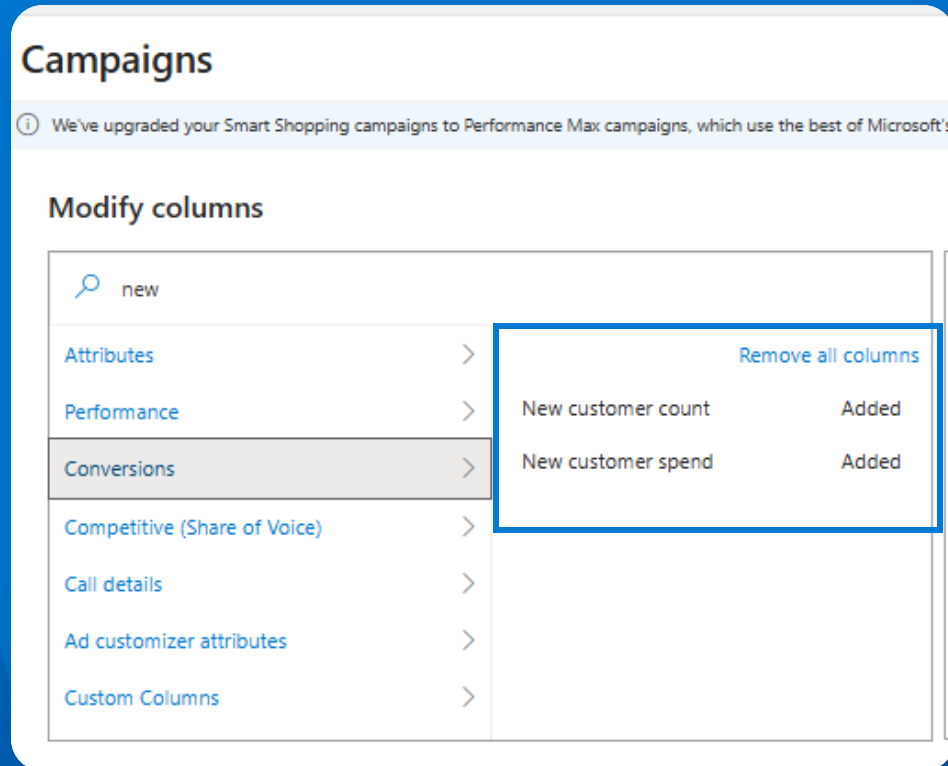
Recommended if you want to:

- Exclusively target new customers.
- If you have strict budgets or creative assets for new users vs. returning users or have non-purchase conversion goals like lead generation.
- Also use this if you already have another PMax campaign focused on all customers.

Reporting options

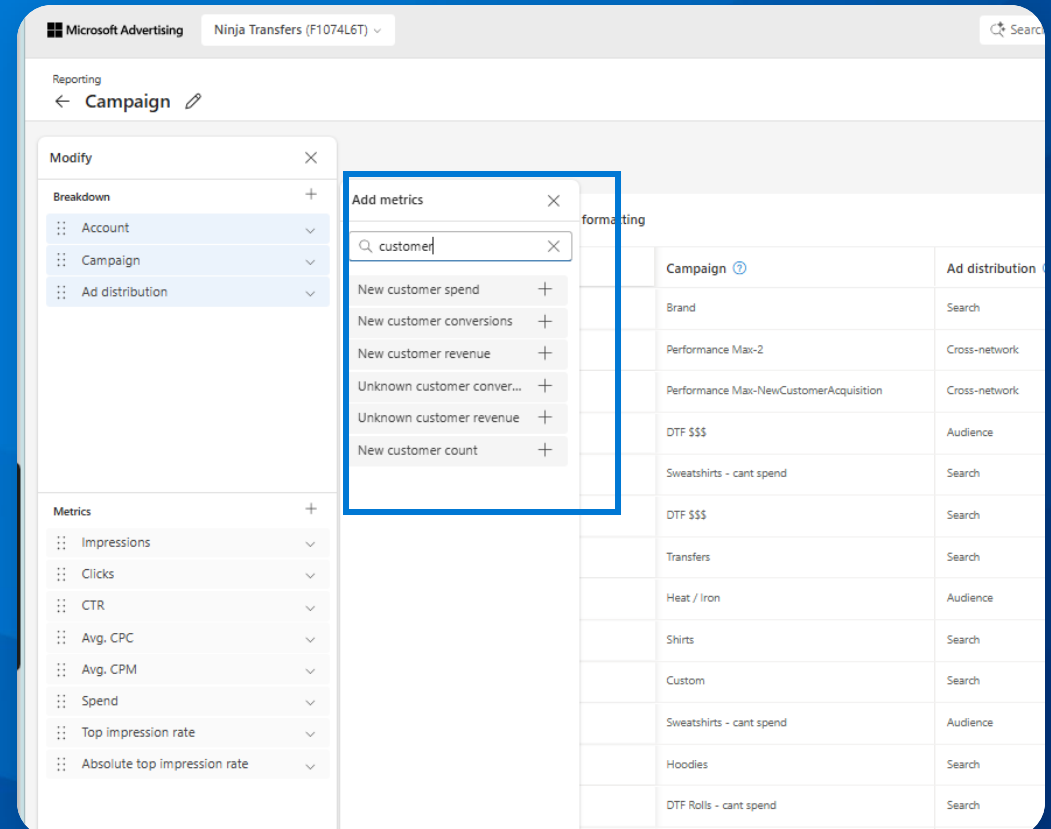
Option 1:

Campaign grid in the UI → Add the respective columns



Option 2:

From the Reporting UI (you'll get more granular data here)



Phase 4: Unbox What's Next



Phase 04 Unbox what's next

– December / January

Monitor, Adapt & Measure

- Monitor **post-holiday performance** to identify new opportunities
- **Refine bids, targets, budgets,** and **messaging** as consumer behavior evolves
- **Adjust strategies** to align with changing demand and seasonal priorities
- Account for **conversion delays** before evaluating campaign success
- Use performance insights and KPIs to identify optimization opportunities
- **Apply learnings to build momentum** and **capture continued growth** post Holiday rush

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 4: From last-minute shoppers to lasting insights

When shoppers are ready to buy



"It's too late to influence holiday purchases in the final days."

"Gift card purchases are the end of the customer journey."

"Consumer spending drops immediately after the holidays."

- Many shoppers pivot to digital options such as gift cards, memberships, subscriptions, and online certificates when physical delivery is no longer guaranteed.
- Last-minute shoppers are highly motivated and often make quick decisions. Urgency-focused messaging, gift guides, and instant-delivery options can drive strong conversion rates.
- Gift cards create a second opportunity to engage customers when recipients redeem them, often generating additional purchases beyond the card's value.
- Post-holiday shopping remains strong as consumers redeem gift cards, take advantage of clearance sales, and purchase items they delayed during the holiday rush.

Right after the peak days, continue monitoring closely and be gradual with changes

1

Adjust bids and targets as needed to continue meeting your KPIs

2

Do not change bid strategies, continue running as-is

Reminder: Check conversion delays when analyzing your performance

Showcasing conversion delay helps advertisers make more informed decisions by revealing how long it typically takes users to convert after interacting with an ad, enabling better attribution, budgeting, and campaign optimization.

Campaigns Auction insights

+ Create | ▾  Status: All campaigns + Add filter

☐	Campaign	↓ Conv. 	Conversion delay 
	Overall total - 108 campaigns	946,440.00 	4
☐	● AutoBidding Status Test 27	 177,680.00 	4
☐	● test faddagarsafdsafdsf	 146,600.00 	4
☐	● ▾ AutoBidding Status Test 23 	 146,600.00 	4
☐	● stand shopping + mcv + no target	 115,520.00 	4
☐	● Test-BothStatus	 115,520.00 	4
☐	● smart shopping + mcv + roas	 84,440.00 	4
☐	● MaxConv-G10909300744	 84,440.00 	4
☐	● Shopping - TRoas - PBS	 53,360.00 	4
☐	● mcv - test 1	 22,280.00 	4

For the selected time range:

Conversions reported as of July 25, 2025: 21.83%

90% of conversions expected in 4 days

99% of conversions expected in 4 days

Real time insights

Visibility into current progress on click to conversion, projecting duration when 90% and 99% of clicks to conversion over times.

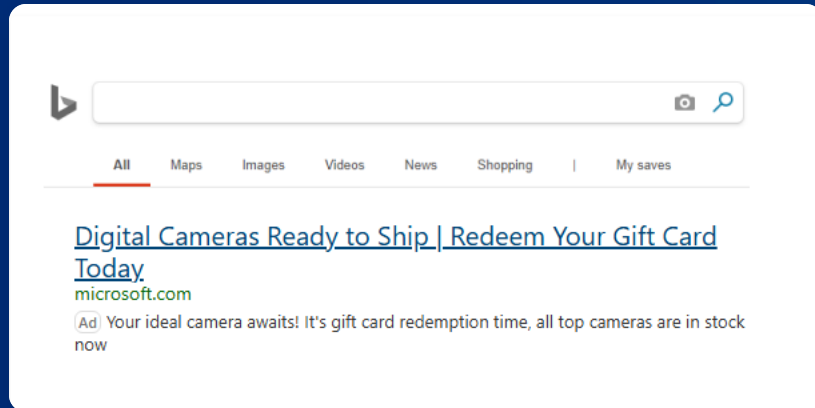
Simplified management

Effortlessly view insights displayed directly as a new metric with a column and a simple hover on conversions.

Note: conversion delay data is only available after 06/01/2025. For any selected time range including 06/01/2025, we will only return conversion delay data after 06/01/2025.

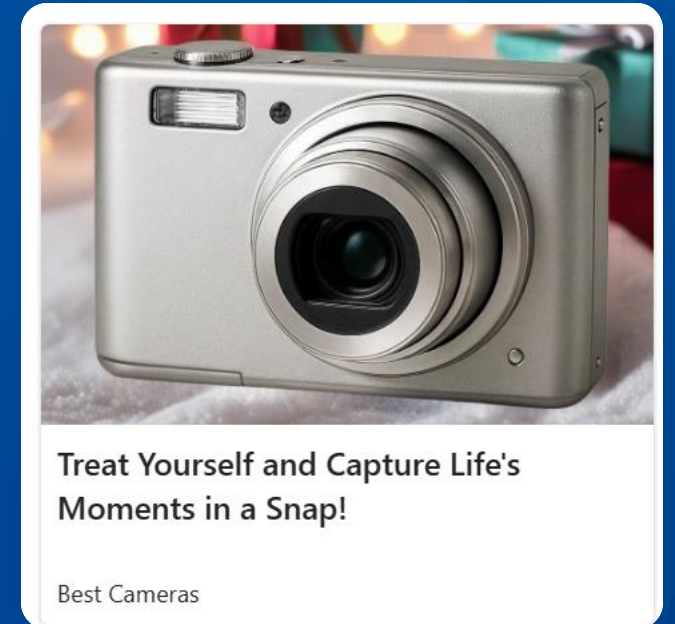
Post-holiday messaging

- Run dedicated gift-card redemption campaigns with bonus-value offers and upgrade promotions.
- Shift from gifting to self-purchase and gift-card redemption messaging.



Extend urgency through limited-time post-holiday and clearance events.

- Refresh creative to align with post-holiday shopper intent and New Year motivations.
- Leverage "treat yourself" messaging to capitalize on growing self-gifting behavior.



Tie the bow — your holiday readiness checklist

Build the foundation

- ☐ Determine the right campaign mix
- ☐ Clarity installed
- ☐ Complete product feed updated / optimized in Merchant Center
- ☐ UCP enabled in Merchant Center
- ☐ UET conversion measurement validated
- ☐ First-party data connected
- ☐ Conversion values enabled
- ☐ Experiments completed

Create demand

- ☐ Audience lists built
- ☐ Audience Ads launched
- ☐ Seasonal audiences activated
- ☐ Holiday creatives uploaded
- ☐ Remarketing strategy live

Capture demand

- ☐ PMax optimized
- ☐ AI Max enabled
- ☐ Promotions scheduled
- ☐ Budget headroom secured
- ☐ Refresh creative and audiences throughout peak
- ☐ Monitor performance daily

Best Practices: AI readiness for product feeds



Upload your entire catalog

Why it matters: AI can only surface products that are in your feed. Upload 100% of your catalog so every product can be discoverable in Copilot shopping — a partial feed leaves the rest invisible.



Complete, accurate product data

Provide titles, descriptions, GTIN/MPN, brand, and category for every item. Rich attributes improve matching and relevance.



High-quality images

Use clear, high-resolution images that meet image requirements. Avoid watermarks, promotional text, and placeholders.



Accurate price & availability

Keep price and stock in lockstep with your storefront. Mismatches are a leading cause of product disapprovals.



Automate feed refreshes

Schedule frequent, automatic feed updates so listings stay current as inventory and pricing change.



Monitor health & fix issues

Review diagnostics regularly, resolve disapprovals quickly, and act on optimization opportunities.